EP 1

1 EXT. STREET - DAY 1

YOUNG HALEY DAVIS (7) has beautiful long hair but wears worn-out clothes. She braves the wind and snow, struggles to push a big cart with roses for sale. Her cheeks are red and swollen from the cold but she puts on a brave face.

YOUNG HALEY
Roses! Fresh roses for sale!

She approaches a passing COUPLE.

YOUNG HALEY (cont'd)
Sir, why not buy a rose for your wife!

The passing couple ignores and shoulder-checks Young Haley, sending her off balance. Haley continues walking. The Grocery store owner (MR. JONES) and his wife (MRS. JONES) see her and sigh with sympathy.

MR. JONES
Haley, I'll take all those flowers.

YOUNG HALEY
(delighted)
Really? Thank you so much, sir!

Mr. Jones takes out several bills from his wallet and offers them to Haley.

YOUNG HALEY (cont'd)
Mr. Jones, that's too much money.

MRS. JONES
Take it, my sweet child. Go treat yourself to something warm and filling.

YOUNG HALEY
Thank you. Mrs. Jones. Thank you Mr. Jones!

Haley skips away. The store owner and his wife exchange concerned looks.

MRS. JONES
Poor thing. She should be carefree and happy at this age, but her father died so early and her mother now has cancer... what will become of this widow and her daughter?

MR. JONES
She’s just a child, yet she's selling flowers in such cold weather to earn money for her mother's medical bills. It breaks my heart.

2 INT. JEWELRY STORE - DAY 2

Young Haley looks at the array of bracelets, remembering something from her past.

BEGIN FLASHBACK

3 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Young Haley peeks through the door crack, watching her mother, CLAIRE WINBURY, negotiate with the LANDLORD.

4 INT. HALEY'S HOME - LIVING ROOM - DAY (FLASHBACK)

The Landlord examines a ladies' bracelet.

LANDLORD
This bracelet is worth $50 at most. Just enough to cover one week’s rent.

Claire is thin and pale. She looks disappointed at the offer.

CLAIRE
Only 50 dollars?
(pleading)
Sir, could you take a closer look?

The Landlord looks uncomfortable as Claire lowers her head.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
I have stomach cancer, it’s terminal...

The Landlord looks surprised.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
The father of my child died when she was an infant.
(MORE)

CLAIRE (CONT'D)
No one takes care of her... I just need a little more time to find someone to look after her, then, I can rest in peace ... Please, take another look...

5 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Hearing her mother, Young Haley's very sad, her eyes well up with tears.

6 INT. HALEY'S HOME -LIVING ROOM - DAY (FLASHBACK)

The Landlord is moved and examines the bracelet again.

CU on the worn bracelet.

LANDLORD
I'm sorry, I must have been mistaken. This bracelet is worth at least $500. This will pay off your previous debts plus next month’s rent.

CLAIRE
(crying with joy, bowing)
That's enough! One month is enough! Thank you, thank you so much!

7 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Young Haley watches her mother, tears streaming down her face.

END FLASHBACK

8 INT. JEWELRY STORE - DAY 8

Young Haley picks up a ladies' bracelet.

YOUNG HALEY
(to herself)
Mom sold the only keepsake Dad gave her for me. Today is her birthday, but I still haven't saved enough to buy her a bracelet...

Young Haley sadly opens her other hand, clutching the dollar bills. Then her eyes light up as she notices the neighboring store.

CLOSE UP on a sign reading "BUYING HAIR! WILL PAY TOP DOLLAR."

9 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM DOORWAY - DAY

Young Haley holds a BOX OF COOKIES and BUSHEL OF ROSES, carefully adjusting her hat to hide her SHORT HAIR. She opens the door to find Claire talking with her grandfather, JAY WINBURY (50).

10 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - DAY 10

CLAIRE
Dad, I don't have much time left...

11 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM DOORWAY - DAY

Haley freezes, horrified and disbelieving.

12 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - DAY 12

Claire grips her father's arm in distress.

CLAIRE
But Haley is so young. I’m begging you, please take her in.

JAY
In your dreams! You left the family to marry that beggar who died young. Now you expect me to raise your bastard child? Abandon this child, and I'll take you back as my daughter. You will get the world's best medical team to treat you.

CLAIRE
Never! Haley is my only reason for living. Even if I die, I'll never abandon my daughter!

JAY
Then I no longer have a daughter. Don't contact me again!

Jay storms out angrily. Claire tries to grab him but nearly falls from weakness.

CLAIRE
Dad, don't go! Please take Haley!
Dad!

Seeing her father leave decisively, Claire can no longer hold back her tears.

13 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM DOORWAY - DAY

Haley hides as Jay walks away. She wipes her tears forcefully. Taking a deep breath, puts on a smile and pretends nothing happened then opens the door.

YOUNG HALEY
Mom, I'm home!

14 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - DAY 14

Claire quickly wipes away her tears, also pretending as she smiles at Haley.

CLAIRE
Sweetheart, you’re back.

YOUNG HALEY
Mom, I saved the prettiest roses for your vase.

CLAIRE
Thank you, darling. You always bring mom the loveliest blooms.

Haley discards the old roses from the vase and arranges the fresh ones.

YOUNG HALEY
Mom, it's your birthday. I wanted to buy you a bracelet, but I couldn't save enough money...

Haley takes out a children's bracelet from her pocket.

YOUNG HALEY (cont'd)
I could only afford this kid's bracelet... Do you like it?

Claire is deeply moved and heartbroken. She nods firmly.

CLAIRE
Of course I like it. You're mommy's biggest pride, this is the best gift I've ever been given.

YOUNG HALEY
(excited)
That's great! Let me put it on for you!

Haley kneels by the bed, carefully fastens the bracelet on Claire's wrist. Seeing this, Claire can't hold back her tears. She turns away, covering her mouth as tears fall.

YOUNG HALEY (cont'd)
All done!

Claire quickly wipes tears and looks at the bracelet, forcing a smile.

CLAIRE
Wow, it's beautiful. Thank you, sweetheart. Having you is my greatest blessing.

Claire gently touches Haley's hand, notices the bruises. Her eyes fill with tears.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
I'm so sorry my sweet... I’m sick, making you suffer so much...

YOUNG HALEY
I'm not suffering at all, but you are. You have to take injections and medicines every day. Mom, today is your birthday, I haven’t made enough money to buy you a birthday cake, but I made you some cookies.

Claire feigns a smile and nods through her tears. Haley opens the COOKIE BOX and hands one to Claire.

YOUNG HALEY (cont'd)
I read that jasmine is good for the stomach. I added jasmine to it, I hope it can makes you feel better. Mom, try one.

Claire takes a bite of the cookie Haley feeds her, chewing thoughtfully. Haley watches expectantly. Claire nods enthusiastically, tears in her eyes.

CLAIRE
It’s so sweet. These are the best cookies I’ve ever eaten.

Haley beams with joy. Claire takes out TWO NECKLACES from under her pillow -- their pendants form a complete heart when joined.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Haley, this is the only thing I own now. We'll each take half of it. Here, let me put it on you.

Claire splits the necklaces, tries to put one on Haley but notices something odd about her hair. She reaches for Haley's hat. Haley tries to dodge but isn't quick enough. Claire freezes.

(ANGLE UP) Claire slowly raises her hand and gently removes Haley's hat, revealing her messily cut, tomboyish short hair. Claire is shocked.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Your... your hair...

YOUNG HALEY
Ah, long hair was too hard to wash. Mom, you're not angry, are you?

Claire looks at Haley's hair, then at the bracelet on her wrist. Fighting back tears, she tenderly strokes Haley's short hair.

CLAIRE
Of course I'm not angry...

Claire puts one necklace on Haley, then puts one on her self.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
We each take half of the necklace. No matter what happens in the future, I'll will never leave you. We will stay together, is that okay?

YOUNG HALEY
Okay!

Claire holds Haley tightly, covering her mouth to stifle her sobs while Haley can't see. Haley hugs her back just as tight.

CUT TO:

Claire sleeps peacefully in bed, her hand tightly gripping Haley's. Haley watches her mother sleep, then carefully slips her hand free. She quietly takes Claire's phone and leaves the room.

15 INT. HALEY'S HOME - LIVING ROOM - DAY 15

Haley speaks into the phone.

YOUNG HALEY
Grandpa, please save my mom!

EP 2

16 INT. HALEY'S HOME - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Claire sleeps while Haley folds her mother's clothes. She discovers several holes in the garments.

CUT TO:

Haley sews the clothes with needle and thread. She pricks her finger, drawing blood. She sucks the blood off and continues sewing. When finished, she admires her work and hugs the clothes tightly to her chest.

17 INT. HALEY'S HOME - BEDROOM - NIGHT 17

Haley places a letter under the rose vase by the bedside table. She watches her sleeping mother and gently kisses Claire's cheek.

YOUNG HALEY
Mom, without me, you'll get better for sure. You must live on. When I become successful, I'll find you and repay all your love in raising me.

Haley stands to leave but takes one step and turns back for another look at her mother. Claire remains asleep. Haley steels herself, and reluctantly departs.

CUT TO:

The wind blows the window open, startling Claire awake. She sits up abruptly, gathering her senses, and looks toward the bedroom door.

CLAIRE
Haley? Haley?

No response. Claire notices the letter by the bedside table. Confused, she picks it up and opens it.

YOUNG HALEY (V.O.)
Mom, forgive me for leaving without saying goodbye.
(MORE)

YOUNG HALEY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
I want to be like other kids, always staying by your side, but I can't let you get worse. Grandpa promised to treat you if I leave. You must get better. Your daughter will pray for you forever. I loves you forever. - Haley

(NOTE: a smiley face is drawn after the word "Mom" in the letter)

Claire's tears fall onto the words “I loves you forever." She breaks down sobbing and struggles to get out of bed.

CLAIRE
No, no...

18 INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Claire, in her nightgown, clutches her stomach while stumbling along the hallway barefoot, steadying herself against the wall. The necklace against her chest swings with each unsteady step.

CLAIRE
(crying hysterically)
Haley! Haley, where are you? Where are you? Don't leave mommy, Haley...

2 PASSERSBY stare at her strangely, but she doesn't care.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Haley! Haley!

Claire staggers out of the hallway.

19 EXT. STREET/CORNER - NIGHT - SNOW 19

Claire stumbles barefoot in the snow, one hand clutching her stomach, screaming Haley's name with all her strength.

CLAIRE
Haley! Haley, where are you? Don't leave mommy... Haley...

Claire staggers, necklace swinging. Suddenly she collapses on the ground, gasping for air. She ignores her body's pain and claws her way forward through the muddy snow, approaching a street corner.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Haley... wait for mommy, Haley...

Jay and TWO BODYGUARDS appear behind Claire, next to a luxury car. One Bodyguard is holding a umbrella for Jay. Claire tries to get up but falls again.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Haley! Haley!

Jay watches her, frowning deeply, and instructs his bodyguards.

JAY
Get the lady into the car.

The Bodyguards pull Claire up from the ground. She struggles.

CLAIRE
Let me go! I need to find my daughter. She's waiting for me!

As Claire is dragged up, around the corner, Haley has drawn Claire's silhouette on the wall with chalk (or snow on the ground). After finishing, Haley crouches against the wall, positioned as if nestled in Claire's embrace.

YOUNG HALEY
(whispering)
Mom, you have to get better, you have to...

Haley hugs herself tightly and falls asleep from the cold, still clutching the necklace her mother gave her.

ANGLE UP. The car carrying Claire passes by Haley. Claire looks down, crying, but doesn't see Haley outside the window.

20 EXT. HAILSBURY GROUP BUILDING ENTRANCE- DAY

SUPER: "18 Years Later"

A luxury car pulls up, and a group of workers stand in two lines, bowing in unison. Claire's assistant, ASHLEY TAYLOR, opens the car door. Claire, dressed in a high-end suit exuding confidence, wears a distinctive half-heart necklace from 18 years ago. Her gaze is determined, her presence commanding, and she steps out of the car gracefully.

WORKERS
Good morning, Chairwoman.

Claire slightly nods. At that moment, 3 JOURNALISTS rush over.

REPORT1
Hailsbury Group has become the world’s leading enterprise under your leadership over the past 18 years. Do you have any feelings or thoughts you'd like to share?

Claire turns and looks at the reporters with a commanding presence.

CLAIRE
Over the past 18 years, I have overcome the toughest challenges and gained the greatest wealth and power.
(looks at the bracelet)
Except one thing, that has been my biggest pain and I’ll never let go.

Claire takes out her phone. The screen shows a photo of Claire with young Haley (7 years old, with long hair).

CLAIRE (cont'd)
This girl is Haley Davis, my daughter whom I lost 18 years ago. I've never stopped searching for her, but have found no trace. From today, every branch of Hailsbury in the world will dedicate resources to finding my daughter. If anyone provides any information, I will reward them - with 10 million dollars!

The reports and workers are shocked, exclaiming "Wow!" and discussing excitedly. The scene becomes lively with chatter.

REPORTER 1
What? Ten million just for a lead?

REPORTER 2
My goodness!

CLAIRE
Whoever finds my daughter will become an honorary director of the Hailsbury Group. Whatever they desire, I will make it happen!

The crowd is shocked again, buzzing with discussion. Claire holds her necklace pendant, examining it carefully with a lost expression.

CLAIRE (V.O.)
My dear daughter, where are you?

21 INT. EVERFRESH FOOD FACTORY - COURTYARD - DAY

Haley (25), wearing a work uniform, hands documents to ETHAN WESTON.

HALEY
Ethan! This recipe took me three years to develop... and it’s for you! When you submit it to the group, they'll surely promote you!

Ethan takes the documents, barely containing his excitement.

ETHAN
Haley, baby, you're amazing! Such a valuable recipe, you're really giving it to me?

HALEY
(embarrassed)
I'm just an ordinary worker, and I don't know much else. If you hadn't saved me six years ago, I might not even exist in this world...

Ethan gently places his hands on Haley's shoulders, comforting her.

ETHAN
No, Haley. You may have amnesia, but you must have been a genius before. This recipe you gave me will definitely win awards. Once the group recognizes me, we'll get married.

HALEY
(delighted)
Okay!

ETHAN
By the way, Haley baby, about the $50,000 down payment for our house... how much have you saved for it?

Ethan gazes at Haley lovingly.

EP 3

22 INT. EVERFRESH FOOD FACTORY - COURTYARD - DAY - CONTINUOUS

HALEY
I've saved over $40k now. A bit more to go.
(MORE)

HALEY (CONT'D)
Ethan, just wait a little longer - once I reach 50 thousand, we can buy the house and get married!

ETHAN
(taking Haley's hand)
Baby, how about this - transfer the forty thousand to me first. I'll give it to the real estate agent in advance. Then when my parents come to the awards ceremony, I'll invite you on stage and propose to you in front of everyone!

HALEY
(delighted, sweet)
Okay, I'll give you the money right now.

Haley hands Ethan a bank card. Ethan takes it and gently pats Haley's head.

HALEY (cont'd)
The PIN is your birthday. Well, I'm off to sell flowers now. Focus on your work and don't worry, I'll save up for the down payment as quickly as possible. Soon we'll be living in our new home together!

ETHAN
(smiling sweetly)
Okay, off you go.

Haley waves and leaves reluctantly. As soon as she turns away, Ethan's expression instantly changes.

ETHAN (cont'd)
What a fool!
(looking at the bank card)
Once I get that recipe award, we won't even be in the same league. Marry me? Not in your wildest dream!

23 INT. HAILSBURY GROUP - HALLWAY - DAY 23

(Note: Claire wears the same outfit until the end and the necklace is always under her clothes, but only revealed to viewers at the end).

Claire walks while checking her bracelet, showing a faint smile. At the corner, she bumps into ASHLEY, who drops her stack of documents.

ASHLEY
I'm sorry, Ms. Winbury. I wasn't paying attention...

CLAIRE
It's fine, I wasn't watching where I was going. Any news about my daughter?

ASHLEY
Not yet...

Claire looks disappointed, then notices a document on the floor, her eyes lighting up.

Close-up on title: "Multivitamin Probiotic Liquid Salad." There's also a Haley's signature smiley face on it. Claire picks up the document, reads it carefully.

CLAIRE
Where... where did this recipe come from?

ASHLEY
These are patent proposals collected from branch companies under our food division.
(looking at the recipe)
This one came from a factory called EverFresh in Portville.

Claire remains excited, looking at the recipe in her hands, lost in memory.

BEGIN FLASHBACK

24 INT. DOCTOR'S OFFICE - DAY 24

SUPER: 20 YEARS AGO

The DOCTOR advises Claire.

DOCTOR
With late-stage stomach cancer, there aren't many foods you can eat. But insufficient nutrition will worsen your condition.
(MORE)

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
Try to eat foods with probiotics that are easily digestible and rich in vitamins.

Young Haley, looking innocent, comforts Claire.

YOUNG HALEY
Mom, when I grow up, I'll develop a liquid salad that has probiotics and lots of vitamins, and it'll be really sweet too! When mom can't eat anything else, she can just drink that!

END FLASHBACK

25 INT. HAILSBURY GROUP - HALLWAY - DAY 25

Claire looks at the recipe excitedly.

CLAIRE
When Haley was little, she said she'd develop a drink that could help people with stomach cancer. And this smiley face...

Claire takes out Haley's farewell letter from her wallet with trembling hands. The letter has the same smiley face on it. Claire and Ashley exchange smiles.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
(tears in her eyes)
It's her, it's my daughter! Quick, prepare the car. I'm going to find my daughter now!

EP 4

26 INT. HAILSBURY GROUP - LOBBY - DAY 26

4 SECURITY GUARDS line up in two rows. Ashley takes a gun from GUARD A and addresses all guards.

ASHLEY
I heard that Portville is not safe. I need everyone to stay alert and ensure the Ms. Winbury's safety at all times.

ALL GUARDS
Yes ma'am!!

27 INT./EXT. CAR/STREET - DAY 27

In the front seat, Secretary Ashley reports to Claire.

ASHLEY
Chairwoman, we're about half an hour from our destination. The food company headquarters just informed us they've identified the recipe's inventor.

CLAIRE
Is it Haley?

ASHLEY
It's a man, named Ethan Weston.

Claire's looks disappointed. Ashley continues reading from her iPad.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
His father is the deputy floor supervisor at EverFresh Food Factory.
(turning a page)
Oh, and he has a girlfriend. They've been together six years.

CLAIRE
(seeing hope)
Girlfriend? What's her name?

ASHLEY
(searching for the name)
It's... Haley Davis!

CLAIRE
(excited)
What? Haley Davis?

ASHLEY
Ms. Winbury, please don't get too excited. Many people have pretended to be your daughter over the years. We can't confirm she's your daughter just based on a name.
(checking documents, surprised)
Oh, this girl also works at EverFresh, and she's donated to their blood drive recently! I'll arrange for DNA testing immediately.

CLAIRE
No matter what, I’m happy with the recipe. Make this awards ceremony grander than ever before. Increase Ethan Weston's bonus from 10 thousand to one million. Also, promote his father to Deputy Manager of the factory.

ASHLEY
Yes, Ms. Winbury. I'll arrange it right away.

Claire looks at her bracelet and gently touches it.

CLAIRE
Haley, Could it be you? Mommy misses your roses. I’d love to get them from you again...

Just then, Claire looks out the window and her eyes brighten. Haley, is selling roses from a cart.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Stop the car!

28 EXT. STREET - DAY 28

Haley waves goodbye to a customer who just bought flowers.

HALEY
Please come again!

Claire happily approaches Haley's flower stand.

CLAIRE
It's so cold today. How can a young girl like you still be selling flowers outside? Your family must be really worried.

HALEY
(smiling)
It's fine. I'm getting married to my boyfriend soon, but we're still short 10 thousand for our house’s down payment. So I’m doing several jobs after my regular work hours.

CLAIRE
What jobs do you have besides selling flowers?

HALEY
After I finish selling flowers, I work at a burger joint, and after that, I clean at a bar. The night shift pays better. I'll do anything for us to live in our own home sooner.

CLAIRE
(eyes twinkling)
I can see how much you love him. You know, my daughter would be about your age. I wonder if she's found someone she loves...

Claire picks up a bouquet.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
I'll buy all of these then!

HALEY
Thank you! But... the one in your hand... I was saving it specially for my boyfriend.

Haley looks embarrassed. Claire looks at the fresh flowers in her hand, moved as she remembers her daughter's words.

YOUNG HALEY (V.O.)
Mom, I saved today's prettiest roses to put in your vase.

CLAIRE
You're such a lovely girl. I hope you can marry to your boyfriend soon.

Claire takes out her wallet to pay. Haley's smiling expression suddenly turns to surprise. She notices the children's bracelet on Claire's wrist.

Cut between the bracelet and Haley's surprised expression.

Ep 5

29 EXT. STREET - DAY - CONTINUOUS 29

Haley stares at the bracelet, hesitating.

HALEY
That bracelet... why does it look so familiar...

Claire puts several bills in the cart's money box. Then she looks at the puzzled Haley.

CLAIRE
What's wrong?

HALEY
(snapping out of it)
Nothing, nothing. Here, ma'am, let me throw in some homemade cookies. I hope you don't mind.

Haley hands over a package of cookies.

CLAIRE
Thank you, young lady.

Claire and her group leave. Haley smiles as she watches them go, then looks down and notices a check tucked between the bills. Haley opens the check and discovers it's for ten thousand dollars, surprised.

HALEY
Oh no, ma'am, this is too much!

Haley runs after them with the money, but the car has already started leaving.

HALEY (cont'd)
I have to find her and return this money to her.

Just then, a female coworker in factory uniform, JENNA JONES, runs up.

JENNA
Haley, quick, back to the factory! Headquarters just announced that the Innovative Foods awards ceremony is happening today. Your boyfriend is going to be the star of the whole factory!

HALEY
(delighted)
Really? Ethan's getting the award today? Oh my god, that means he's going to propose to me today...

JENNA
Yes, let's hurry!

Jenna and Haley run off, pushing the cart.

30 INT. CAR - DAY 30

Claire looks at the cookies in her hand, remembering the past.

INSERT: EPISODE 1, CLAIRE GIVES HALEY COOKIES.

Claire nods happily through her tears. Haley opens the cookie box and hands one to Claire.

YOUNG HALEY
I read that jasmine is good for the stomach. I added lots of jasmine, so when your tummy hurts and you can't eat, these cookies will help you feel better. Try one, Mom. Is it good?

Claire takes a bite of the cookie Haley feeds her, chewing thoughtfully. Haley watches expectantly. Claire nods enthusiastically, tears in her eyes.

CLAIRE
Sweet and crunchy. These are the best cookies mom has ever tasted.

Haley beams with joy.

END INSERT.

31 INT. CAR - DAY - CONTINUOUS 31

Claire looks at the cookies, somewhat sad.

CLAIRE
Haley Baby, mommy miss you so much...

Claire holds back her sadness, takes out a cookie to look at it, then puts it in her mouth. After two chews, her expression changes.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
This taste...

Claire looks at the cookie in surprise, then becomes extremely excited.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
This is the taste of jasmine! It's Haley! Quick, turn around, go back to where we bought the flowers right now!

32 EXT. STREET - DAY 32

Claire gets out of the car, runs to where the flower stand was, but finds it empty.

CLAIRE
(panicked)
Haley! Haley! Where did she go?!

ASHLEY
Ms. Winbury, she was wearing an EverFresh factory uniform. The Innovative Foods awards ceremony is today, everyone from the EverFresh factory has to attend.

CLAIRE
Yes, you're right. To the factory, right now!

Claire hurries back to the car.

33 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 33

Factory workshop environment. Cold dishes and wine. The backdrop, banners, and stands read "HAILSBURY GROUP & EVERFRESH FACTORY - INNOVATIVE FOODS AWARDS CEREMONY". 20 GUESTS are present - 10 in factory uniforms and 10 in formal attire, chatting in small groups.

Ethan, wearing a suit, stands below the stage, accepting flattery from guests.

GUEST 1
Mr. Weston, The Hailsbury Group's arranged such a grand feast to celebrate your recipe. The chairwoman must really value your abilities!

ETHAN
(pleased)
Just randomly threw something together. Never thought the chairwoman would like it. I consider myself lucky.

GUEST 2
Getting an award for just "throwing something together"? Mr. Weston, you're a genius! Your future is limitless!

Ethan basks in the praise as others nod in agreement. MARISSA WESTON (45, Ethan's mother) comes over.

MARISSA
My son has been smart since he was young. He is much brighter than most people.

GRACE WESTON (25, Ethan's sister) chimes in.

GRACE
Exactly! This recipe is just my brother testing the waters. Once he gets serious, with his abilities, he'll definitely get promoted to corporate headquarters!

Ethan holds his head high proudly as others nod in agreement.

CROWD
(overlapping)
That's right! / So admirable!

Claire and Ashley enter the banquet hall. Ashley points at Ethan.

ASHLEY
Mrs. Winbury, that's Ethan Weston.

Claire looks at Ethan with an approving smile, then slightly furrows her brow.

CLAIRE
Where's his girlfriend? The girl called Haley?

Claire and Ashley scan the crowd.

Haley runs in carrying the bouquet of roses, wiping sweat from her forehead. She immediately spots Ethan talking among the crowd. Haley gazes at Ethan adoringly, her expression full of worship and pride.

HALEY
Ethan looks so handsome today... Soon he'll propose to me in front of everyone. I'm so blessed...

Haley dusts off her work uniform, looks at the flowers in her hands, smiles determinedly, and walks toward Ethan.

Ashley notices Haley passing by and alerts Claire.

ASHLEY
Ms. Winbury, look! It's that flower-selling girl!

Claire's eyes light up as she looks at Haley. Haley makes her way through the crowd, waving to Ethan.

HALEY
Ethan, I'm here!

Hearing Haley's voice, Ethan doesn't even look at her, turning instead to walk onto the stage. Ethan taps his wine glass, drawing everyone's attention as they quiet down and gather around the stage. He flashes a confident smile.

ETHAN
Good evening everyone. Welcome to my award ceremony. To be honest, for all I've achieved till now... I must especially thank one woman who has supported me all these years.

The crowd applauds. Haley, hearing this, breaks into a shy smile.

ETHAN (cont'd)
Without her brilliant idea and help, I could never have reached the heights I have today. She is my everything, someone I would protect with my life forever! So on this special day, I want to express my gratitude to her.

Haley's close coworkers, JENNA JONES and LILA LEIGH (40-50s), exchange knowing glances, happy for her.

JENNA
These six years haven't been easy for Haley. To save for the house down payment, She's been working 24/7, she has like four jobs!

LILA
Yes, besides working here, she's been selling flowers, waiting tables, and staying up late researching recipes. Look at her hands, they are always bright red from the cold!

Haley, hearing her coworkers, bashfully rubs her hands.

JENNA
Haley's a good girl. She's finally made it through. I'm so happy for her.

ETHAN
Today, I not only want to thank her, but I, Ethan Weston, want to propose to her! I will spend my life protecting her, cherishing her!

The crowd applauds, gathers around Haley, who looks shyly toward Ethan with anticipation. Claire is moved, exchanging smiles with Ashley as they applaud.

ETHAN (cont'd)
This girl is--

Haley can barely contain her smile as she prepares to step forward.

ETHAN (cont'd)
Miss Vanessa! Vanessa Nelson!

Haley freezes, her smile vanishing. Claire's smile also fades, confused. Others exchange bewildered looks. Ethan steps down from the stage, inviting Vanessa up. The crowd murmurs in disbelief.

VANESSA NELSON (25) enters the banquet hall wearing a beautiful evening gown. She deliberately bumps Haley hard when passing her, then putting on an sweet expression walks onto the stage, placing her hand in Ethan's.

Ethan kisses Vanessa. Through their kissing scene, Haley watches in disbelief, clutching her chest in extreme pain.

JENNA
What... how could this happen?

The crowd looks at Haley as she staggers backward, watching the couple on stage. Claire's eyes are full of sympathy.

EP 7

34 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 34

Vanessa pulls away and playfully pushes Ethan. He holds her hand, deeply affectionate.

ETHAN
I could never win this award without Vanessa's support.
(MORE)

ETHAN (CONT'D)
Babe, you gave me direction when I was lost. You spent three years tirelessly helping me research recipes. Without you, I wouldn't have this honor today.

VANESSA
Darling, it's nothing. After all, we're so in love.

HALEY
What are you saying... That recipe... I was the one who helped you with it.

Haley stares blankly in disbelief, looking up at Ethan. On stage, Ethan raises Vanessa's hand, gesturing to the crowd.

ETHAN
Vanessa and I have decided to hold our wedding in three days!

Ethan lifts Vanessa's hand, her diamond ring sparkling. Haley's face shows deep hurt. Claire is also shocked. The workers are stunned.

JENNA
Getting married?

LILA
What? They are getting married?

The crowd whispers. Someone recognizes Vanessa.

GUEST 1
I know, she is Miss Nelson! The niece of the factory manager!

Haley looks at Guest 1, who continues. Ethan intimately embraces Vanessa.

GUEST 1 (cont'd)
I remember she graduated from Harvard University. She's educated and beautiful - Such a match for Mr. Weston!

GUEST 2
Not just that, I heard that Miss Nelson's father is the vice president of the Portsville branch of Hailsbury Group! She's only works here just for the namesake.

GUEST 3
My goodness, that Ethan’s really married into a wealthy family!

HALEY
It can’t be!

Haley's fights back tears, turning to protest. Nearby, the previously happy Marissa and Grace look at Haley with disgust.

HALEY (cont'd)
Ethan said he would marry me. There must be some misunderstanding.

GRACE
(pushing Haley away)
What’s there to misunderstand? A poor nobody like you wanting to marry my brother - that's the real misunderstanding!

MARISSA
Exactly! I'm warning you, if you dare to make a scene here, I'll break your legs!

HALEY
No, that’s impossible, I need to ask Ethan myself!

Ignoring Marissa and Grace's attempts to stop her, Haley rushes to the stage.

HALEY (cont'd)
Ethan, is there a mistake? Didn't you promise to marry me?

Vanessa looks displeased as she looks at Ethan. Ethan nervously rushes down from the stage and immediately slaps Haley hard across the face.

ETHAN
(viciously)
Marry you? In your dreams!

Haley holds her face, staring at Ethan in disbelief as her flowers scatter across the floor.

EP 8

35 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 35

Ethan points at Haley with disgust.

ETHAN
Look at you—so poor and pathetic! Coming to my awards ceremony dressed like this is embarrassing enough. How dare you dream of marrying me? Go find yourself a mirror, you think you can measure up?

Haley looks at her work uniform, deeply hurt, staring at Ethan in disbelief.

HALEY
Ethan, how can you say that? You know I've been saving for our down payment. That's why I haven't bought new clothes for so long. To build a home with you.

ETHAN
Home? An orphan like you, some parentless stray dog from god knows where... you want a home with me?

Claire clenches her fists angrily. Haley shakes her head, crying heartbrokenly.

HALEY
It’s true I don't know who my parents are, but I gave you all my love. I did all your family's laundry and cooking every day, worked overtime, stayed up late researching recipes... Now you tell me you're marrying someone else, that I'm not worthy...

ETHAN
Enough! Laundry, helping with recipes - is that what I really need? Any woman off the street could do that! And you wanna brag about that? Haley, you really have no class.

HALEY
(heartbroken, incredulous)
What did you say?

ETHAN
What I need is a woman with connections who can help me rise. Not some parentless trash like you.

GRACE
(mocking)
Exactly! Doing our laundry and cooking - you chose it yourself! Did my brother ask you to? Serving our family is the greatest privilege you'll ever have. Just because of that you think you can marry my brother? You're delusional!

MARISSA
That's right. Our whole family just saw you as a free maid! We never even thought of letting someone low-class like you become part of our family!

Haley shakes her head in tears, Claire watches Haley with deep sympathy.

MARISSA (cont'd)
Only a noble lady like Vanessa is worthy of spending life with my son.

Vanessa straightens up proudly, Ethan points at Haley with disgust.

ETHAN
Understand now? Then get out! Don't make me get my hands dirty slapping you again!

Claire burns with anger, about to step forward to teach Ethan a lesson, but Ashley quickly holds her back.

ASHLEY
Ms. Winbury! We can't confirm she's the young miss yet. Please wait - the DNA results will be out soon.

CLAIRE
(suppressing rage)
How much longer?

ASHLEY
15 minutes, we'll definitely have the results.

CLAIRE
Get it done in three minutes, at all costs!

ASHLEY
Understood!

Ashley quickly sends messages. Claire grits her teeth and clenches her fists as she watches the stage. Vanessa holds onto Ethan, deliberately acting intimate as she mocks Haley.

VANESSA
Darling, who is this peasant? Coming to your awards ceremony dressed like a beggar.
(sniffs)
Ugh, when was the last time she showered? She stinks!

ETHAN
Just a simp who won't leave me alone!

Coworkers point accusingly at Ethan. Guests whisper among themselves. Haley smiles bitterly through tears.

HALEY
So in your heart, I'm just a simp for you.

Ethan smirks coldly. Claire watches him with angry eyes.

HALEY (cont'd)
Ethan Weston, we've been together for six years... For every minute, every second, I pour my whole heart--

ETHAN
Shut up! You're just a poor, ignorant nobody! How much is your heart even worth?
(hugging Vanessa)
Your six years of “heart” aren't worth one kiss from Vanessa!

MARISSA
Exactly! A goddamn orphan, thinking of marrying my son - what a fantasy! If you upset Miss Nelson, we won't be so polite anymore!

Vanessa walks up to Haley, looking down her nose at her.

VANESSA
Today is my fiancé's award ceremony. I'll let you off easy - be smart, disappear right now. After all, I don't think you want to know what happens when you anger me, do you?

HALEY
Do you know that without me, there wouldn't be an award ceremony today!

Ethan stares speechless. The crowd erupts in whispers.

GUESTS 1 & 2
(overlapping)
What does she mean? / What?

Ethan angrily raises his hand to slap Haley again.

ETHAN
Who do you think you are? Daring to yell at Miss Nelson?

Ep 9

36 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 36

Claire grits her teeth in anger, clenching her fists, her face ashen.

CLAIRE
They’re dead meat! How much longer until we get the results?!

ASHLEY
One minute at most.

Ashley checks her phone before reporting back. Haley covers her cheeks, slowly raising her head with tears in her eyes, looking at Ethan.

HALEY
Ethan Weston... so this is who you really are.

Ethan sneers, holding Vanessa close. Vanessa looks extremely pleased.

VANESSA
What, did that slap wake you up? Someone like you...
(poking Haley while speaking)
(MORE)

VANESSA (CONT'D)
...a poor working-class nobody, society's most trashy bottom-feeder, what right do you have to pine after an excellent man like Ethan?

Vanessa cups Ethan's face, giving him a kiss. Haley points at Vanessa angrily.

HALEY
You!

VANESSA
(grabbing Haley's finger roughly)
Me what?! You dare talk back to me?
(shoving Haley hard)
Haven't you figured out your place yet? You're just a lowly worker, no money, no influence, and I hear you don't even have parents? Let me tell you, if you died right here, nobody would give a fuck - you're worth less than my pet dog. While I'm the heiress of the Nelson family! I have eminence and status that a lowlife like you could never imagine!

Vanessa extends her right hand, her engagement ring glittering.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Take a good look at this South African diamond.
(showing her earrings)
And these limited edition jewels. They add up to exactly FORTY THOUSAND DOLLARS.

HALEY
(stunned)
What are you trying to say?

VANESSA
(moving close to Haley, whispering in her ear)
I'm saying the money you earned working dozens of jobs, scrimping and saving for that house of yours? He spent it all on my jewelry.

Haley turns to look at Vanessa, disbelieving, clutching her chest as tears fall.

VANESSA (cont'd)
But you know what? I don't care about the scraps you saved up. If you want it back, I can give it to you, I could even add some extra. Just get on your knees and beg... After all, you poor, homeless thing, you'll need that money for your own funeral!

Haley's eyes redden.

HALEY
Stop it!

She shoves Vanessa away.

VANESSA
Ah! You dare push me!

ETHAN
How dare you touch my fiancée! Do you want to die?

Ethan violently kicks Haley to the ground.

Ep 10

37 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 37

Haley falls to the ground, with Jenna and Lila rushing to help her up.

JENNA
Haley, are you okay?

LILA
This is absolutely outrageous!

Lila stares at Ethan. Claire looks extremely anxious, checking the clock on the wall, then glaring at Ethan and Vanessa.

VANESSA
Trash will always be trash. I gave you a chance to leave, but you insisted on a beating! You know what, since today is my fiancé Ethan's award ceremony, I'm in a good mood. So I'll give you a toast!

Vanessa smiles as she picks up a glass of wine and pours all of it on the floor. The crowd gasps. Haley glares at Vanessa hatefully.

VANESSA (cont'd)
If you get on your knees and lick up all this wine, I'll spare your worthless life. Otherwise, I'll tear up that cursed face of yours right now!

Claire is furious, anxiously watching the clock and looking at Ashley. Ashley keeps staring at her phone, afraid to miss the DNA results message.

ETHAN
Haley, oh Haley, if you had just left quietly, none of this would have happened. Now you've upset my fiancée, and when she's unhappy, I'm unhappy. And whatever she tells you to do, you fucking do it!

GRACE
Did you hear that? If it weren't for Miss Nelson's kindness, you'd never be able to taste such expensive wine! Better take the chance while you can!

Marissa and others laugh mockingly. Haley speaking each word clearly.

HALEY
Even if I die, I won't give in to scum like you.

VANESSA
(laughing wildly, clapping)
I didn't expect a bitch like you to be so stubborn! OK, I'll rip up your face today. Let's see how thick your skin really is, how long you'll keep up this act! Guards!

3 SECURITY GUARDS appear with baseball bats surrounding Haley.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Hold her down!

Haley tries to dodge as the guards approach but can't resist their strength and is forcibly held down. Vanessa picks up a baseball bat, smiling slightly.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Ethan, didn't you say you'd do anything for me? Why don't you do the honors this time?

Vanessa hands the baseball bat to Ethan, who doesn't take it immediately. Everyone, including Haley, watches Ethan intently. Ethan smiles slightly and takes the bat. Haley is so disappointed. Vanessa shows a satisfied smile.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Haley Davis, I really pity you. But think about it, you should feel honored. After all, the man you've loved for six years will destroy that shameless face of yours with his own hands!

HALEY
(struggling)
Let me go! You bastards, let me go!

VANESSA
Of course I could spare you, but that depends on whether the love of your life plans to do.
(looking at Ethan)
Darling, it's your decision.

Haley looks at Ethan. He swings the bat while walking to Haley step by step.

ETHAN
Haley, don't blame me for being heartless. It's a world where the weak are prey to the strong. Lower-class people like you are worthless than stray dogs. Being playthings for upper-class is what you deserve. We've known each other for a while, and I could have spared your life, but you had to offend my fiancée. Now, you must die!

Close-up: Ethan raises the baseball bat to strike Haley's head. Ashley nervously checks her silent phone. Claire covers her mouth with both hands, extremely anxious. Ashley's phone chimes, and she looks at it with joy.

ASHLEY
Ms. Winbury , Miss Davis, she... she IS your biological daughter!

Claire's eyes flash with shock, then joy. She turns to Ethan, as he is about to strike Haley. Haley closes her eyes tightly and turns away as the bat descends.

Close-up: As Haley dodges, her necklace falls out from her collar, swaying on her chest. Claire immediately notices Haley's necklace.

CLAIRE
(joyful, eyes shining)
My daughter...

The baseball bat is about to hit Haley. Claire's expression changes from joy to fierce determination. She extends her hand.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Give me the gun!

Ashley quickly places the gun in Claire's hand. Claire raises the gun, aiming forward with resolute eyes.

Close-up: Just as Ethan uses all his strength to swing the baseball bat, a GUNSHOT rings out.

Close-up: The bat's top is hit and EXPLODES in mid-air. Ethan falls from the impact, the bat rolling away. The crowd cowers in terror.

Marissa and Grace cover their heads, staring at the scattered bat in shock. Ethan lies on the ground, looking terrified toward the source of the gunshot. The crowd parts. Claire stands expressionless but fierce, holding the gun. Vanessa looks toward the newcomer.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Who dares to touch her!

Ep 11 (PAYWALL)

38 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 38

Claire glares fiercely at Ethan, who is helped up by Vanessa and clutches her tightly. Claire and Ashley walk to them. Haley stands up looking at her, the necklace swaying on her chest. The crowd looks at Claire, talking loudly.

CROWD
Who is she? /How does she have a gun?

Marissa, also frightened.

MARISSA
(To Grace)
Who... who is she?

Ethan's hands shake slightly, which Vanessa notices and grabs.

ETHAN
How... how does she have a gun...

VANESSA
What are you afraid of? It's just a gun. Here is Goldwyn, my family's territory, are you really scared of some old hag?

Claire ignores Ethan, walking straight to Haley. She caresses Haley's bruised face, deeply pained, tears glistening in her eyes.

CLAIRE
My girl, does it hurt?

HALEY
Ma’am, it's you... I'm fine but why are you here?

CLAIRE
It's all my fault. I'm sorry I came late. I’ve let you suffer so much.

VANESSA
Hey, you old whore, who let you in? Don't tell me you're here to back up this little bitch?

CLAIRE
(gently pats Haley)
I AM here to back her up. All those who bullied her, I'll make them beg for death to no avail.

Claire looks at Ethan and Vanessa.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
You two...

Claire raises the gun, aiming directly at Ethan's head.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
...are doomed!

Ethan cowers back in panic, while Vanessa pulls him to stand firm. Grace raises her arm to hide in fear.

Haley is also shocked seeing the gun, looking at Claire. The crowd backs away fearfully, questioning.

CROWD
Why does she keep waving her gun around? /Let's see how Miss Nelson handles her!

Hearing the crowd's comments, Vanessa has to step forward, putting on a brave face and shouting.

VANESSA
You crazy old hag. Do you know who I am? I'm the Nelson family heiress! My uncle’s is the factory director! My dad, the vice president of Hailsbury Group's branch in Goldwyn! Touch one hair on my head, and my father will kill your entire family!

Marissa and Grace nod repeatedly. Claire keeps her gun raised, unmoved.

CLAIRE
Vice president of the city branch? How impressive!

VANESSA
Haha, now you’re scared? I guess having a gun doesn’t make you impressive. Just revealing my identity was enough to frighten you!

CLAIRE
It’ll be worse if I choose not to use the gun. Well then, since you’re so proud of your background and act above the law! I’ll play along with you today!
(gives gun to Ashley and instruct)
Go and get my men.

ASHLEY
Yes, ma’am.

Ashley looks at Ethan and Vanessa, her eyes full of malice.

Ep 12

39 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 39

VANESSA
Ridiculous! You wanna dance with me? You might lose your life today, you hag!

HALEY
(trying to stop Claire)
Ma'am, you can't afford to offend them. Please go. I can't let you get involved.

Claire looks at Haley tenderly, smiling.

ETHAN
Too late! You've offended Miss Nelson, you're both dead!

CLAIRE
(coldly looking at Ethan)
You're Ethan Weston, right? For six years, Haley was completely faithful to you, toiling tirelessly for you. She loved you so much, yet here you are... betraying her, calling her low-class trash, even trying to destroy her face! Don't you fear karma will come to get you?!

ETHAN
A penniless, powerless simp of an orphan. What karma could I get?

CLAIRE
A simp? In order to marry you, she worked three night jobs on top of her day job!

Haley shakes her head tearfully. Marissa looks disgusted.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
It turns out you're such a disloyal, money-grubbing scumbag!

ETHAN
A worthless woman like her deserves to die unmarried! You want me to marry her? Do you know my status now? Do you know why this award ceremony today is so grand?
(MORE)

ETHAN (CONT'D)
The Hailsbury Group headquarters pulled out all the stops for me! She's not worthy of me at all!

CLAIRE
Shut up! Your status? Everyone knows that you got the reward because Haley gave you her recipe.

JENNA/LILA
That's right! /This was Haley's recipe!

Coworkers support Haley, giving her some comfort. Ethan is contemptuous.

ETHAN
Fine, I'll admit it. That recipe is indeed Haley's. So what? The fact that I accepted anything from her is a blessing for her!

Ep 13

40 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 40

CLAIRE
Have you ever thought that everything you own now, can be taken away at any anytime?

Ethan moves closer to Claire, giving her a contemptuous look before laughing loudly.

ETHAN
What? Taken back? What nonsense are you spouting, old hag! My promotion, my raise, my accolades - they're all approved by Headquarters!

CLAIRE
Ethan Weston, since you didn't invent this recipe, your so-called promotion, raise, and this award ceremony will all gone. They're not for you.

ETHAN
Are you going to report me then? Let me tell you, I'm not only favored by the Hailsbury Headquarters, I'm also about to marry into the Nelson family!

Vanessa smiles smugly.

ETHAN (cont'd)
Who the hell are you? You must have a death wish to oppose me!

VANESSA
(holding Ethan's arm)
Old hag, Ethan is my fiancé now. You better know your place. Let me tell you, Nobody in Goldwyn City dares to go against the Nelson family! Let along a small town like Portville. You think your surname is Winbury?

Vanessa and Ethan burst into laughter. Haley tries to persuade Claire.

HALEY
Please leave quickly. The Nelson family is powerful. I'm... not worth you offending them. But don't worry, I'll email headquarters about the recipe's true origin. I'll take responsibility for any consequences!

Vanessa displeased, Claire looks at Haley, nodding with satisfaction.

VANESSA
(pointing viciously at Haley)
You bitch, are you asking for death? Email? You dare send an email? I'll kill you right now!

CLAIRE
Miss Nelson, how imposing of you!

VANESSA
(smiling smugly)
Let me enlighten you before you die! This factory employs over 1,000 people, all under my uncle's command.
(pointing at Haley)
Including this bitch! Want to bet that with one word from me, I can have you stripped naked and kicked out to beg on the streets?

41 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 41

MARISSA
Scared stiff, aren't you? My son is part of the Nelson family now, and you two bitches dare think about reporting to headquarters? I'll chop off your hands if you do it!

GRACE
(pointing at Haley)
Lifelong trash like you, you could write 10 thousand emails and no one would care!

HALEY
You can't cover up everything! I don't believe it!

VANESSA
Don't believe it? You won't learn until you're dead. I'll have you fired right now! Listen up, with one word from me, no one in this entire city will dare give you a morsel of food!

Vanessa tries to approach Haley, but Claire immediately blocks her. The crowd murmurs, and Haley's close coworkers look worried.

ETHAN
Haley, all you've done since losing your memory is work in this factory. You have no education, no connections, and you just gave me all the money you've earned. If you're fired, you'll probably starve to death on the streets.

Haley looks down defiantly, clenching her fists.

ETHAN (cont'd)
If you kneel in front of Vanessa now and apologize, lick her shoes clean, I can still plead for you, give you a way to survive.

CLAIRE
(standing in front of Haley)
Ethan Weston, very soon, you'll deeply regret betraying and humiliating Haley. You'll be crying and begging for her forgiveness!

VANESSA
(laughing mockingly)
Hahaha, what did you say? You want my fiancé, the Nelson heiress's future husband, to kneel and beg forgiveness from someone worth less than a stray dog? Fine...
(to Haley)
If die right here, Ethan and I will visit your grave to pay our respects.

HALEY
You!

CLAIRE
(pointing at Vanessa)
You won't escape either! I don't care who your uncle is, or who your father is. If they dare show up today, one by one, they'll all be on their knees groveling for mercy!

Ep 15

42 INT. JOHNSON'S OFFICE - DAY 42

JOHNSON NELSON (45) reviewing reports. His phone RINGS. CLOSE UP on phone screen showing caller: "Ashley Taylor." Johnson hurriedly puts down his work and stands, answering the phone respectfully.

JOHNSON
Miss Taylor, to what do I owe the pleasure of your call?

ASHLEY
Johnson Nelson, you're doing such a great job as factory director that your niece has become completely lawless!

JOHNSON
(terrified)
What?

ASHLEY
Get to the factory right now, or face the consequences!

JOHNSON
(panicked)
Is Ms. Winbury at the factory? Yes, yes, I'm heading there now!

Johnson hangs up and runs out.

43 INT. WATTS' OFFICE - DAY 43

WATTS SCOTT (50) wearing a suit, listens to his phone in shock. His SECRETARY stands nearby with notepad, waiting for instructions.

WATTS
What? The heiress of the company has been found? In our city?
(to secretary)
Write this down.
(continues listening)
EverFresh Food Factory in Portville? Yes, yes, I'll head there right away.

SECRETARY
I'll prepare the car.

The Secretary exits, Watts follows closely behind.

44 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 44

VANESSA
How insolent! Dreaming that my uncle and father would kneel and beg you? You're the first person who’s ever dared be so arrogant in front of me. Guards! Break this old bitch's legs. Then throw her out! I'll show her what happens when you mess with me!

Haley rushes forward to protect Claire.

HALEY
What are you doing?! If you want to hurt someone, come at me!

VANESSA
Don't worry, you'll die even more miserably than her! Get them!

As several Guards move to surround them, Claire shields Haley.

CLAIRE
Let’s see who dares!
(looks at Vanessa with contempt)
I don't care about your family or pedigree. Today you threatened Haley, so you’re doomed. No one can save you!

ADAM (O.S.)
Someone’s talking big!

ADAM WESTON (45) enters, followed by TWO SECURITY GUARDS.

Claire turns to look at him, expressionless. Marissa smiles upon seeing Adam.

Ep 16

45 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 45

Ethan and Grace light up at Adam's arrival.

GRACE
Dad!

ETHAN
Dad! You finally made it!

ADAM
Did I miss your award ceremony?
(frowning at Sophia and Haley)
What's going on here?

ETHAN
(exasperated)
Dad, it's all because of that bitch Haley. She made Miss Vanessa upset, and worse, she brought along this crazy woman who demanded that you, Vanessa and I kneel down and apologize to them!

ADAM
(angry)
What?!
(to Haley)
You worthless brat, are you tired of living?

CLAIRE
(approaching Adam)
So you're Ethan Weston's father? The deputy floor supervisor Adam Weston? Why don't you ask your precious son, what he did to Haley?

ADAM
(contemptuous)
To Haley? She's nothing but a useless orphan who clings to my son!

Haley clenches her fists, glaring at Adam.

ADAM (cont'd)
My son is talented and accomplished. Anything he does to her is a gift! And who the hell are you to criticize my son? Don't you know where you are?

CLAIRE
An ungrateful bully who abuses his power. So your son is so shameless because he takes after his evil father!

ADAM
You sharp-tongued old hag, who are you to judge me? Fine, let's see how tough you really are. I'll knock all your teeth out!

HALEY
Don't touch her!

Haley quickly moves to block Claire. Adam slaps Haley hard across the face.

ADAM
Get lost! I'll deal with you next, you little tramp!

Ethan, Vanessa, and look on with smug satisfaction.

Ep 17

46 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 46

Claire quickly checks Haley's face, her eyes full of concern.

CLAIRE
My girl, are you alright?

HALEY
(reassuring)
I'm fine.

Ashley returns to report.

ASHLEY
Ms. Winbury, everything's arranged. Our group's people will all arrive within 10 minutes.

CLAIRE
Excellent.
(to Haley)
Don't worry, they'll pay for that slap a thousand times over!

ADAM
Who's going to pay for what?

CLAIRE
Soon you'll be on your knees, slapping yourself and begging for Haley's forgiveness!

ADAM
Still spouting nonsense? Take her down!

The bodyguards advance with clubs, raising them to strike Haley.

HALEY
(blocking the bodyguards)
Stop!

ADAM
You brat, I don’t see you for one day and you dare defy me? You must want to die!

Adam grabs a club from one of the bodyguards and moves to strike Haley. Claire shields Haley while two of Haley's coworkers grab the club, wrestling it away and throwing it to the ground.

JENNA
You’ve gone overboard!

LILA
Yes! How can you bully Haley!

ADAM
Bully Haley? So what if I bully her? If you all oppose me, I'll deal with you the same way! Get out of here!

JENNA
I won't! All these years, Haley has been like family to us. She has no blood ties to you, but just because she loved Ethan, she devoted herself to all of you without complaint!

LILA
That's right! You're like vampires, using her and then turning on her like beasts. If you bully Haley today, I won't stand for it!

HALEY'S COWORKERS
(in unison)
Right! /We won't allow it!/ Same goes to us!

Adam, humiliated and enraged, slaps Jenna hard.

ADAM
Stop yapping! You’re just cattle in my factory! Now you want to rebel? You don’t think I’ll fire every single one of you?!

Ep 18

47 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 47

Haley and others quickly help Jenna up.

HALEY
(worried)
Jenna, are you okay?

JENNA
I'm fine. Don't be afraid of him!

ADAM
Aww, you’re like sisters! Today I'll break both of Haley's legs. If you're so loyal, you can take her place and become disabled!

JENNA
No! I won't let you hurt Haley no matter what.

Haley is deeply moved.

ADAM
Jenna Jones, did you forgot your paralyzed mother is still lying in her hospital bed? She relies on your measly salary for her treatment! Keep causing trouble and I'll fire you in a second and your mother will die on the streets!

Jenna staggers back in shock, helpless.

ADAM (cont'd)
(To Lila)
Your daughter's about to graduate, isn't she?

LILA
(terrified)
What are you planning to do?

ADAM
What am I planning? Not only will I fire you, but I'll also put your daughter on Hailsbury Group's blacklist!

LILA
What? Hailsbury Group's blacklist...

ADAM
Hmph! With Hailsbury Group's influence, your daughter will need to go find an alley to beg in once she finishes her studies.

Adam slaps Lila. Haley tries to stop him but is too late.

ADAM (cont'd)
And the rest of you! Anyone who wants to throw their life away, step up and keep supporting this worthless trash!

The coworkers exchange worried glances, afraid to step forward. Haley looks at everyone with concern.

ETHAN
Haley, see how unlucky you are? Everyone who associates with you gets cursed. If I were you, I'd just die and hope to be reborn into a family that won't throw you away like garbage!

HALEY
Adam Weston, they have nothing to do in this. Don't get them involved!

ADAM
They dared to disrespect me. I'll make sure they go down, with you!

Ep 19

48 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 48

JENNA
(angry)
Adam, you're just a deputy supervisor in the factory. You have no right to fire all of us!

COWORKERS
Yeah!/ That's right!/ Who do you think you are!

ADAM
(smirking)
Deputy supervisor? That's old news!

Marissa and Grace exchange expectant looks. Adam pulls out an APPOINTMENT LETTER from his jacket, displaying it to the coworkers.

ADAM (cont'd)
Open your eyes and take a good look at this!

CLOSE UP on the appointment letter reading "Personnel Appointment: Effective immediately, Adam Weston is appointed as Deputy Director of Hailsbury Group’s EverFresh Food Factory."

The coworkers look on in shock.

COWORKERS
Deputy Director? /How is this possible?

ADAM
This appointment comes directly from the branch office, with Hailsbury Group's official seal! I am now the Deputy Director of Hailsbury Group's EverFresh Food Factory!

Claire smirks contemptuously. The coworkers appear panicked.

JENNA/LILA
This, this can't be.../ how could you become...

Ethan looks smug, pulling Vanessa closer. Grace jumps around happily.

GRACE
Dad, you're promoted? I'm a director's daughter! Our family’s gonna be rich!

Marissa holds Grace's arm, equally smug. Jenna step forward.

JENNA
No! Even if you fire me today, I won't stand by and let you bully Haley!

Others agree, standing united behind Haley. Haley is deeply touched.

ADAM
(furious)
What a bunch of ignorant people, Fine, you're all fired! Now get lost!

CLAIRE
What authority do you have to fire them?!

ADAM
(contemptuous)
What authority? The authority of being this factory's Deputy Director! And them? They're just livestock working for me!

CLAIRE
From now on, with me here, you can't touch any of them.

Adam pretends to be scared, then reveals a mocking expression.

ADAM
Oh really? I'm so scared! Hahaha!

CLAIRE
Laugh while you can, because your position as Deputy Director, ends here!

49 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 49

Adam shoves the appointment letter in Claire's face, arrogantly.

ADAM
Ends here? Open your dog eyes and look here, this letter has Hailsbury Group's seal. Who do you think you are?!

Claire smirks contemptuously, then coldly snatches the appointment letter and tears it to shreds. Everyone is shocked. Even Haley is in disbelief.

ADAM (cont'd)
You!

Claire throws the shredded letter in Adam's face, speaking harshly.

CLAIRE
Do I need to repeat myself? Your time as Deputy Director is over!

ADAM
(furious, pointing at Claire)
How audacious! How dare you tear up the appointment letter with Hailsbury Group's seal, You're dead!

CLAIRE
Adam, let me remind you again - not only will you not be Deputy Director, you won't even keep your current position as floor supervisor!

ADAM
(laughing)
Acting so high and mighty, cancelling my promotion and firing me? Someone might think you're the factory director!

CLAIRE
(contemptuous)
Director? If a mere factory director laid eyes on me, they'd have to bend their knee!

ETHAN
(stepping forward)
Are you crazy, old hag! Do you even know what you're saying?

HALEY
Ma'am, don't get yourself in trouble for me. I'm not worth it.

Claire gives Haley a reassuring look. Adam points at Claire, enraged.

ADAM
How dare you! Not only provoking me but disrespecting our factory director!

ETHAN
I see this old woman doesn't plan to leave here alive today.
(snaps fingers)
Guards!

Ep 21

50 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 50

As Guards move to surround them, Haley stands in front of Claire.

HALEY'S COWORKERS
What are you trying to do?!

CLAIRE
Child, don't worry. Just watch the show.

Haley looks worried but nods. Claire turns to Adam and the others.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
I never imagined a small factory under the group would have so many bullies. Today, I'm going to clean house.

ADAM
Old crone, you've probably never even had a job! In this world, you need power and connections. Who are you to clean up here?!

CLAIRE
Adam Weston, You'll get the answer soon. And these workers you think you can fire at will? I won't let you touch a single hair on their heads.

ADAM
Still putting on an act? Guards! Strip this old woman down, let's see if she still acts so high and mighty!

VOICE (O.S.)
Factory Director Johnson Nelson has arrived!

Adam quickly straightens his clothes and puts on a fawning smile, looking toward the door. Johnson strolls in, talking to himself.

JOHNSON (V.O.)
Ms. Winbury is personally attending this award ceremony - this is a rare chance to interact with her. I must do well, can't let anyone upset her. If she’s happy, I might get promoted!

Haley steps forward but Claire gently holds her back, comforting her. They turn their backs to Johnson's direction. Ethan's family and Vanessa approach Johnson. Johnson sees everyone gathering around and asks.

JOHNSON
What are you all doing?

VANESSA
(affectionately)
Uncle, why are you here?

Ethan's family shows great respect to Johnson. Adam bows to Johnson.

ADAM
Mr. Nelson, what brings you here?

JOHNSON
(respectfully, serious)
I'm here to welcome a very important person!

Everyone looks surprised.

VANESSA
Important person?

JOHNSON
Yes, someone so important that even seeing them once is an honor! I've had the fortune to meet them before and will never forget it.
(seriously)
I'm telling you, there can't be any trouble at today's award ceremony. If this VIP takes a liking to us, our family's fortunes will soar!

VANESSA
Uncle, don't worry, I'll have these troublemaking bitches thrown out right away!
(ordering Adam)
Mr. Weston, what are you waiting for?
(look at Haley and Claire's back)
Throw them out immediately!

Haley takes a nervous deep breath, while Claire looks confident in her victory.

EP 22

51 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 51

Adam bows eagerly.

ADAM
Yes, Miss Nelson!

Adam takes a club from a guard and approaches Haley and Claire.

ADAM (cont'd)
Old hag, our factory director is here. Didn't you say that you'd make he bow and kneel to you?
(raising the club)
What's wrong, too scared to turn around?

Haley turns around angrily. Claire holds Haley's hand. She slowly turns around, face cold, raising her eyes to look fiercely at Johnson. Johnson sees Claire's face and can't believe his eyes.

CLAIRE
Johnson Nelson, as factory director, you sure are imposing!

Johnson is extremely shocked, unable to speak, clutches his heart in distress.

ADAM
How dare you mouth off to Mr. Nelson! You're asking for death!

Johnson's chest pain worsens, his expression agonized as he slowly drops to his knees. Vanessa supports him, very surprised.

VANESSA
Uncle, what's wrong? Don't scare me!

Adam turns to look at Johnson. Claire watches with amusement.

JOHNSON
It's over. Oh no, everything's over!

Vanessa is confused. Others start murmuring among themselves.

CLAIRE
You see, Adam Weston? I keep my promises - he's already kneeling. You're next!

ADAM
Ignorant bitch! You planned this, didn't you? Deliberately causing trouble before the VIP arrives! You've given Mr. Nelson a heart attack!

Johnson clutches his chest watching the arrogant Adam, too angry to speak.

ADAM (cont'd)
Quick! Rip out this bitch's tongue and make her kneel in repentance!

Haley’s shocked. Johnson quickly stands up, points at Adam, gritting his teeth.

JOHNSON
You Bastard! Stop right now!

EP 23

52 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 52

Johnson slaps Adam down. Marissa quickly helps Adam up as the crowd gasps and murmurs in surprise. Claire watches with a blank expression.

JOHNSON
What the hell. Did you leave your brain at home? Do you know who she is? You dare to disrespect her!

Adam gets up and kneels on the ground, turning to the boss.

ADAM
Mr. Nelson, isn’t she just an old hag?

JOHNSON
(kicks Adam down)
You fool! Do you know that anything you just said could bring doom to your entire family?!

Haley looks at Claire, confused. Claire smiles back at Haley.

ETHAN
Uncle, you must be mistaken. This old woman, with her widow's look, has no right to threaten our family! She’s just a crazy person.

GRACE
Exactly! Mr. Nelson, Don’t let this worthless woman fool you.

JOHNSON
Still talking back, huh? How dare you!

Johnson slaps Adam three times in a row.

ETHAN
Dad!

JOHNSON
Adam Weston, you’ve been reckless and unrepentant. I have to punish you!

ADAM
(in disbelief)
Mr. Nelson, it’s these rotten workers who need discipline! I’m just fulfilling my duties as a deputy manager.

JOHNSON
Duties, huh? Fine. I hereby dismiss you as deputy manager. You and your son are both fired, and will never be re-hired!

Ethan’s family is shocked and panicked. Adam has a distraught expression.

ADAM
What? My deputy manager position is gone?

Haley breathes a sigh of relief. Haley’s colleagues cheer.

ETHAN
(in disbelief)
I’m fired?
(grabs Vanessa)
Honey, my dad just taught them a lesson. Why is your uncle firing us?!

VANESSA
Uncle, are you mistaken? How can you fire my fiancé and my father-in-law just for this old hag?

JOHNSON
Shut up! Do you realize the mess you’ve caused?

VANESSA
(annoyed)
What mess? I was just helping my fiancé teach a lesson to this stupid bitch!

Johnson meets Claire's cold gaze and quickly slaps Vanessa again.

JOHNSON
Keep your mouth shut!

Vanessa looks at her uncle in disbelief.

EP 24

53 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 53

Johnson grabs Vanessa's wrist.

JOHNSON
Do you have any idea that if you keep this up, our entire family is going to face disaster?

VANESSA
What’s wrong with you today! You’re actually defending this bitch?
(MORE)

VANESSA (CONT'D)
Do you have any idea how many lowly people like her I could step on in a month?!

JOHNSON
(applying more pressure)
You better stop talking like that! If you keep going, I won’t recognize you as my niece anymore! Get down on your knees and apologize to her!

VANESSA
You're hurting me! Let go!

Ethan pulls Vanessa away, and she shoves her uncle hard.

VANESSA (cont'd)
(furious, pointing at Claire)
Apologize to her? My knees are worth more than her life! You old hag, you really know how to seduce men. I have to say, your figure is still pretty good even at your age. No wonder my uncle is infatuated with you.

Johnson quickly covers Vanessa's mouth.

JOHNSON
Stop it! Do you realize that our entire family is in trouble? Do you want to get us all killed? Kneel down and apologize, or no one will be able to save you!

Johnson presses down on Vanessa. She angrily pushes him away.

VANESSA
Don’t fucking touch me!
(pointing at Claire)
You old vixen. I don’t care if my uncle is smitten with you. I’ll tell you this, I have plenty of ways to deal with you!

EP 25

54 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 54

Johnson lunges to grab Vanessa. She slaps him hard. The crowd is stunned.

JOHNSON
You dare hit me?

VANESSA
I’m hitting you, you treacherous scoundrel! Don’t forget, the only reason you’re the boss here is thanks to my dad! Without him, you’re nothing!

The crowd whispers in astonishment.

GRACE
Turns out the job was given to him by Miss Nelson’s father. Wow, she is quite powerful!

ETHAN
Of course! Vanessa is not like Haley, who doesn’t have any background! So what if you’re the manager? You’ll only end up getting beaten in front of my dear fiance!

JOHNSON
(pointing at Vanessa)
Fine, I’ve tried to reason with you. Vanessa Nelson, hear me clearly—your actions have ruined your dad and your family!

VANESSA
(laughing)
That’s rich! My dad is the vice president of the Hailsbury Group’s branch in Goldwyn city!

Ethan’s family shows satisfied and proud expressions.

VANESSA (cont'd)
I’m telling you, my dad is on his way here! By the time he arrives, you’ll suffer, and so will this old hag you’re protecting!

JOHNSON
(bowing to Claire)
I’m sorry. Please rest assured, I’ll kick them out immediately!

EP 26

55 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 55

CLAIRE
No need for that. Didn't she say her dad is coming? I'm curious to see how much of a pest a small branch of the Hailsbury Group can bring!

Claire crosses her arms as the manager bows.

JOHNSON
Got it!

VANESSA
Old hag, do you see this? You think you can control me just by calling Johnson Nelson? You're only fooling him, a man who's never seen the real world.

GRACE
My dear sister-in-law, you're amazing!
(looks at Claire)
And you, You're dead meat!

VANESSA
After all, the Nelson family is one of the top families in the city. I could throw money at you and bury you with it!

HALEY
Ma'am, her dad is the vice president of the Hailsbury Group's branch in Goldwyn. All the companies here have to watch their step around the Nelson family. I know you're a businesswoman, you don't need to risk yourself only for me.

CLAIRE
Don't worry, dear. Does she dare to compare financial might with me? She's already lost.

Haley hesitate for a moment and nods earnestly. Claire's gaze sharpens as she looks at Vanessa.

56 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 56

ETHAN
(laughing)
Not only are you as blind as a bat, but who the hell do you think you are to flex in front of Miss Nelson? Haley is just a filthy beggar, and being close to her, what does that make you?

VANESSA
Old hag, you want to compete with me in wealth? You're utterly ignorant! Do you know that the wedding gifts I prepared today alone could scare you to death?

CLAIRE
(smirking)
I'd love to see what precious treasure it is that could possibly scare me.

VANESSA
What's the point of your stubbornness? Let's make a bet. If you can't bring out something more valuable than mine, you and that filthy worker, Haley Davis, will have to crawl out of here on your knees!

CLAIRE
Fine. If you lose, you'll kneel and apologize to Haley. And you—
(pointing at Ethan)
—you'll soon realize you've missed a real chance at upward social mobility.

ETHAN
(laughing maniacally)
Are you seriously saying that your wealth is greater than Vanessa's? Without Johnson Nelson, you're still here holding strong? That's quite a show you're putting on!

VANESSA
Fine, we'll do it your way. Today, I'm going to make you regret it, no excuses.

HALEY
(sincerely)
Ma'am,
(beat)
Don't take the bet.

CLAIRE (V.O.)
I've been preparing the wedding gifts for my daughter for quite long time. Now, it's finally time to bring them out.

CLAIRE
Don't worry, dear. I've already prepared my wedding gifts as well. If they want to compete, let's give them a real show.
(indicates Ashley)
Go, bring over what I prepared.

ASHLEY
Yes!

Ashley exits.

ETHAN
What could a beggar like you possibly offer, besides some worthless junk no one wants? If you dare to bring it out, I'll smash it all!

VANESSA
(clapping three times)
Bring my gift here!

THREE ATTENDANTS walk in carrying three covered, and everyone leans in to look.

MARISSA
Miss Nelson's wedding gift is bound to be something priceless!

GRACE
Mom, that's a given! Miss Nelson could pull out any random item from her house and it would scare Haley and that old hag to death!

They share a smug glance, Haley looks worriedly at Claire. The attendants place the gifts on the table then leave. Vanessa struts over to the gifts.

VANESSA
You bunch of lower-class poor fucks. Today I'll show you exactly how big the gap between us!

EP 28

57 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 57

Vanessa lifts the cover off the first gift, revealing a large stack of cash.

VANESSA
My first wedding gift: $200,000 cash!

Claire shakes her head with a light laugh. Ethan, Grace, and Marissa cover their mouths in shock, eyes wide with joy. The onlookers whisper.

MARISSA
In cash! I've never seen so much money in my life. Truly worthy of Miss Nelson, just this first wedding gift is something that Haley, that beggar, could never see even if she worked her whole life!

Marissa and Ethan glance at Haley, who looks downcast.

VANESSA
My second wedding gift, is a Lamborghini sports car for Ethan, worth $600,000!

The crowd buzzes with envy.

GRACE
Oh my gosh! A $600,000 sports car! My dear sister-in-law, can I get a ride sometime?
(pointing at Claire)
What can this old hag even compare with?

Claire shakes her head dismissively with a smile. Vanessa smirks, then uncovers the third gift.

VANESSA
Listen up, this last wedding gift, is The Imperia Chateau Villa No. 9, worth $8 million!

The crowd holds up fingers to show the number 8, utterly stunned.

ETHAN
What? Imperia Chateau Villa? The most expensive area in Goldwyn City? The people who live there are either high-ranking officials or international stars!

Haley turns her head aside, feeling a bit defeated.

ADAM
I heard there are a total of 20 villas in that area, and the closer to the front, the more luxurious and expensive they are! No. 9 is such a prominent number. Miss Nelson, you truly are a force to be reckoned with!

VANESSA
Forget about this town, even in this entire city, how many people can afford something like these? Old hag, are you wide-eyed now? Just admit defeat already!

Claire crosses her arms, scoffing lightly, then turns to Vanessa.

CLAIRE
Admit defeat?

EP 29

58 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 58

ETHAN
What else could it be? Miss Nelson’s wedding gifts are something lowlife like you will never afford. You could starve yourself and save every penny for a lifetime, and you still couldn't afford it. Soon, you’ll have to crawl!

GRACE
Exactly! Only that villa, people like you could spend a lifetime’s savings and still couldn’t buy a single toilet in there.

Marissa and Adam smirk. Haley looks worried, Claire remains at ease.

HALEY
(worried)
Ma'am, maybe we should—

CLAIRE
Don't worry, dear. The show is about to begin.

Haley nods. Claire walks past the smirking Ethan, approaching the gifts. She picks up a stack of cash and casually throws it back on the table.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
You think you can scare me with this?

VANESSA
What did you just say?

CLAIRE
You heard me! Don't bring out these worthless gifts and embarrass yourself!

Claire flips the table over. Vanessa rushes over in shock, all stands stunned.

GUEST 1
This woman really doesn't know her limits.

MARISSA
You filthy whore! Are you crazy? Those gifts are worth more than your life!

VANESSA
How dare you touch my things, you old bitch? Who do you think you are?

CLAIRE
Your wedding gifts are worth nothing compared to mine!

EP 30

59 INT. BRIAN'S OFFICE - DAY 59

BRIAN LANGE (50) is looking at stock trends on his computer when KAYLA LANGE (26, elegant attire) approaches him.

KAYLA
Dad, what’s so urgent.

BRIAN
Daughter, this matter concerns your father’s career. If it goes wrong, I might lose my job.

KAYLA
What? You’re the general manager of Hailsbury Group’s state branch. What could possibly get you fired?

BRIAN
I have prepared a gift. You need to personally deliver it to an employee named Ethan Weston at the EverFresh food factory in Portville, right now.

KAYLA
What kind of a dump is that? Why would I personally deliver a gift to some low-level employee?

BRIAN
Daughter, this Ethan Weston is the future son-in-law of the chairman of Hailsbury Group. Don’t you think he’s worth it?

KAYLA
The chairman of Hailsbury Group... Okay! I’m leaving right now!

BRIAN
Right. We can’t let anyone else get there before you. I’m heading to the airport immediately, the bigwigs from all Hailsbury departments should be arriving soon.

KAYLA
Got it! Let’s split up!

The two quickly leave the office.

60 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 60

Vanessa mocks Claire.

VANESSA
You’ve barked for ages but where's your wedding gift? Hmph!
(MORE)

VANESSA (CONT'D)
If you can actually pull out something more valuable than what I brought, I'll kneel and lick your shoes!

Claire smiles as she looks toward the door. FOUR ATTENDANTS carrying wedding gifts walk in, followed by FOUR BODYGUARDS with money boxes. The crowd parts automatically, all showing expressions of surprise.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)
First wedding gift: a blue beauty sapphire rough stone, worth $500,000! Second wedding gift: a Fabergé egg, worth $800,000!

Ethan and Adam are stunned, Marissa is shocked as she clutches the cash. The Bodyguards open the money boxes.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.) (cont'd)
Third wedding gift: cash, $2 million!

Haley looks at Claire in astonishment, while Claire confidently crosses her arms. Marissa looks at Claire in disbelief as cash scatters around.

MARISSA
Million?! That's ten times more than what Miss Nelson had!

Ethan looks at Vanessa with frustration, while Vanessa is left speechless.

CROWD
Million!

JENNA
(pointing at Vanessa, laughing)
$200,000, ha ha ha!

ASHLEY
Fourth wedding gift: a custom Faraday yacht, worth $8 million!

Grace and Ethan almost lose their balance, Vanessa is utterly speechless.

GRACE
$8 Million! That's worth more than all of Vanessa's gifts combined!

CROWD
A custom yacht! That's incredible!

ASHLEY
Fifth wedding gift.

All looks to the entrance as Ashley walks in with TWO BODYGUARDS, and an attendant carrying the key for Villa No. 1. Ethan's expression is one of despair.

EP 31

61 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 61

ASHLEY
Fifth wedding gift: Villa No. 1 in Imperia Chateau, worth… $100 million!

Vanessa nearly faints, while Marissa and Grace are left flustered and helpless.

ADAM
Villa No. 1 in Imperia Chateau? That’s the ultimate symbol of prestige! You can’t just buy it with money; you also need immense power!

Everyone stands in shock, unable to steady themselves.

CROWD
Did I hear that right? $100 million?!

VANESSA
No, this can't be!

Vanessa rushes to the attendant holding the room key, grabs it, inspects it.

VANESSA (cont'd)
It’s real, it really is Villa No. 1. Even my dad can’t afford it; why...

Vanessa collapses to the ground, looking at Claire in disbelief.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Why… how can you, you old woman?

HALEY
Ma’am, did you prepare all of this?

Claire smiles and gently strokes Haley's arm.

CLAIRE
Dear, this is just the appetizer. The main course is about to be served.

Claire turns to the still-shocked Ethan.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Ethan Weston, all of these things were originally meant for you.

Ethan almost stumbles, his eyes wide open.

ETHAN
What? Prepared for me?

EP 32

62 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 62

Ethan approaches Claire with a beaming smile.

ETHAN
Ma'am, there's been a misunderstanding.

Marissa and Grace quickly join in, smiling awkwardly.

MARISSA
Yes, yes, it's all a misunderstanding.

CLAIRE
So, when you see the good stuff, it's all a misunderstanding?

ETHAN
Oh, Ma'am, please, let me explain.

Ethan raises his hand to explain, but Claire grabs his wrist firmly.

CLAIRE
Didn't you say I was a beggar, and that the things I brought were junk? Didn't you want to smash them all?

Marissa quickly shakes her head, and Ethan forces a smile.

ETHAN
Oh, no way! The things you brought are the most precious in the world. I would never dare to smash them!

CLAIRE
You shameless gold digger!

Adam and Grace's smiles falter awkwardly. Ethan continues to force a smile.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Wouldn’t dare to smash them? OK, I’ll help you!

Marissa tries to intervene but hesitates. Claire drags Ethan to the gifts.

Claire lifts the blue beauty sapphire and looks at Ethan before letting go. The sapphire falls to the ground and shatters into three pieces.

All gasps in shock and disbelieve. Vanessa, still on the ground, recoils in fear.

Whispers ripple through the crowd, Everyone shows a look of pity. Ethan watches the shattered sapphire on the floor, heartbroken.

ETHAN
Ahhh! My blue beauty! My $500,000!

EP 33

63 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 63

Claire uses her index finger to gesture at the first attendant withdraws. Marissa points at the shattered sapphire on the ground in disbelief.

MARISSA
Did you just smashed a $500,000 sapphire?!

Claire forcefully pulls Ethan over to the Fabergé egg, and Ethan looks terrified.

CLAIRE
Go ahead.

Ethan tries to jerk his hand away in fear, but Claire grabs him again.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Weren't you going to smash it?

ETHAN
Ma’am, wait, you can't smash that! It’s a Russian Fabergé egg, worth $800,000!

Claire picks up the egg, raising it high into the air as Ethan’s eyes widen.

ETHAN (cont'd)
No, no, no!

Claire lets go, the egg crashes to the ground, shattering into pieces.

CLAIRE
What’s $800,000? What’s important is Haley. You vain man who tramples on her feelings, you don’t deserve to have any of these gifts!

Ethan looks at the egg, tears welling up in his eyes. Claire signals to Ashley.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Take it all away.

ASHLEY
Yes!

Ethan rushes over to Haley, grabbing her hand.

ETHAN
Haley, please convince her, not to take the gifts back! I’ll propose to you; let’s go buy a house and get married right now! Okay?

Ethan smiles at Haley, who looks at both him and Claire, waiting for an answer.

Haley glances at Ethan and Claire before shaking off his hand.

HALEY
I don’t want to!

Claire looks at Haley with appreciation.

CLAIRE
Remove everything!

The Attendants and Bodyguards bow and withdraw. Ethan watches them leave, collapsing onto the floor. Marissa, Grace, and Adam look on with regret.

ETHAN
(desperate)
I can’t believe I missed the chance for a class transition.

MARISSA
How does Haley know such a wealthy woman?

Claire walks over to Haley, smiling as she takes her hand.

CLAIRE
Dear, come with me.

They walk over to where Vanessa is sitting on the ground, looking terrified.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Vanessa Nelson, the gifts I gave are worth a hundredfold more than yours. According to our bet, shouldn’t you kneel and lick Haley’s shoes now?

Vanessa looks over at Haley with fear.

EP 34

64 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 64

Vanessa is slumped on the ground.

VANESSA
What bet? Stop talking nonsense!

CLAIRE
(looking down)
You don’t want to admit it? Alright then, hold her down for me.

Claire’s people step forward to restrain Vanessa.

VANESSA
(panicking)
What are you doing? Let go of me! If you lay a finger on me, my dad will kill you!

Ethan’s family is in a panic. Haley's expression is cold.

CLAIRE
(fiercely)
Even when your dad arrives, he’ll kneel on the ground and repent for having raised such a brat!

Claire picks up a stick from the ground, hands it to Haley, her tone softening.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Dear, she hit you before, so return it to her.

Haley is about to take the stick when Vanessa yells a threat.

VANESSA
Haley Davis! If you dare to touch me, I'll make you regret it for life!

Haley firmly takes the stick, gripping it tightly, her expression resolute.

HALEY
I won't. Because it's what you deserve!

Haley raises the stick and with all her strength, swings it toward Vanessa. The crowd watches in anticipation, some covering their eyes.

CONNER (O.S.)
Stop!

Haley halts the stick above Vanessa's head, looks to the entrance. Claire's cold gaze also shifts to the door. Vanessa's fear shifting to joy.

CONNER NELSON strides in angrily, flanked by 2 BODYGUARDS. The crowd is intimidated. Vanessa shove a bodyguard away, rushing to Conner.

VANESSA
Dad! You finally came to save your darling daughter! These bastards were just about to hit me! You have to get revenge for me!

Haley clenches her fists while Claire remains undaunted. Conner anxiously checks Vanessa for injuries.

CONNER
What? Who dares to hit my baby girl? They must be tired of living!

Conner glares fiercely at Claire and Haley.

EP 35

65 EXT. EVERFRESH FOOD FACTORY - DAY 65

Two cars pull up to the entrance, FIVE ATTENDANTS step out, each holding a cash-filled suitcase.

They line up in two rows, respectfully waiting for the people in the luxury car to exit. An attendant opens the door for Kayla.

Kayla, wearing sunglasses, elegantly brushes her hair behind her ear, then steps out of the car. Kayla looks up at the sign of the food factory, and just then, her phone RINGS. She answers the call.

KAYLA
Hello, Dad.

BRIAN (V.O.)
Have you arrived? Make sure not to mess it up, our Lange family's depends on you!

KAYLA
Don't worry, Dad. I'm at the entrance now. I promise I'll handle everything beautifully!

Kayla hangs up, takes off her sunglasses, revealing a determined smile. She gestures for everyone to follow her.

KAYLA (cont'd)
Let's go.

The 2 follows Kayla as they enter through the gates of the food factory.

EP 36

66 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 66

HALEY
(pointing the stick at Vanessa)
She proposed the bet, and lost, so she should fulfill her promise!

VANESSA
You're full of crap! When did I lose?

HALEY
Everyone here can testify that Madam's gift is worth way more than yours!

CROWD
Yes! / I can testify! / You lost!

Vanessa glares around, pointing at them.

VANESSA
Shut up! What are you all shouting about, you bunch of poor fucks? Do you want to die?

CLAIRE
Vanessa Nelson, no one can go back on their word in front of me, especially you!

Claire points at Vanessa, her wrist revealing a children's bracelet. Conner notices it and snickers derisively.

CONNER
You almost had me fooled there.
(grabbing Claire's wrist)
Look at what you're wearing—what garbage!

Haley is shocked to see the children's bracelet.

CONNER (cont'd)
A children's bracelet! Its value is probably less than ten bucks!

The crowd glances at the children's bracelet, whispering among themselves.

ETHAN
Children's bracelet? I knew an orphan like Haley couldn't possibly know wealthy people, it's all coming to light now!

Haley looks at the bracelet, as if recalling something.

HALEY
This bracelet...

Haley feels a wave of dizziness and ringing in her ears.

EP 37

67 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 67

VANESSA
Haha, a children's bracelet? Damn, I almost fell for your acting. So, are the gifts you gave just now all fake?

GRACE
Miss Nelson is right! They must be fake. Why else would she be in such a hurry to take them away? She’s afraid of getting exposed!

CONNER
If you want to pretend to be wealthy, you should at least buy a decent bracelet!

Conner flips his wrist to show off his gold watch.

CONNER (cont'd)
A ten-dollar children's bracelet! Did you buy that at a dollar store? Wearing it out in public—aren't you embarrassed?

VANESSA
Old hag, take a good look! What my dad wears!

Conner shoves the watch in front of Claire's face.

VANESSA (cont'd)
A Rolex worth over a hundred thousand! Now that’s a symbol of wealth! Only a broke ass like you would wear a plastic bracelet, got it?

Claire remains expressionless. Ethan’s family shows proud and appreciative expressions. Claire looks at her own bracelet.

CLAIRE
(with a warm smile)
This bracelet is my most treasured possession.

Conner and Vanessa look at her disdainfully.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Don’t think that your dad's measly watch worth a little over $100,000 means anything. Even if it were worth $1 million or $10 million, it wouldn’t compare to this one.

Once Claire finishes her fierce statement, she looks tenderly at her bracelet again. Ethan's family rolls their eyes mockingly. Vanessa smirks.

VANESSA
Everyone, listen to this crazy woman. A cheap children's bracelet, and in her mouth, it becomes priceless. I'm curious—how is it that a watch worth over a hundred thousand is less than your cheap children's bracelet?

Adam points at Claire, laughing as he shares a glance with Marissa.

CLAIRE
This bracelet was a birthday gift from my daughter when she was seven. She worked hard, even sold her hair, just to save enough money to buy it for me. It has been 18 years. Nothing in this world can compare to this.

Conner scoffs derisively. Vanessa crosses her arms, wearing a smug grin.

VANESSA
Oh, now I get it...

Suddenly, Vanessa grabs Claire's wrist and yanks the bracelet off her arm.

Haley tries to stop her but is too late. Vanessa triumphantly holds up the bracelet.

VANESSA (cont'd)
So it was your daughter who gave it to you. If I smash it to pieces, wouldn't that hurt you to death?

CLAIRE
(angrily)
Don't you dare!

EP 38

68 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 68

VANESSA
You think you can scare me? You're not even worthy of that. Seeing you so anxious makes me more excited to smash it... Hahaha!

CLAIRE
I warn you, if you dare to damage that bracelet, I will have you pay with your life!

VANESSA
What did you say? Have me pay with my life? Fine, my dad is right here!

Conner strokes his bracelet, looking smug. Vanessa throws the bracelet into the air. Claire looks shocked, nervously watching it fall back into Vanessa's hands.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Come on, what are you going to do about it?

ASHLEY
It's over, this is the reverse scale!

HALEY
Reverse scale?

ASHLEY
Yes, there was a financial tycoon who mocked the Ms. Winbury's bracelet as cheap and ugly. Ms. Winbury flew into a rage on the spot, ordered a full attack on that company. Within half a day, he was forced to declare bankruptcy!

HALEY
Just for saying one bad comment about the bracelet? That led to someone's bankruptcy?

ASHLEY
Not just that. That person couldn't even get a janitorial job afterwards. He ended up on the streets, worse off than a beggar.

Marissa rolls her eyes at the story, mocking.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
This Vanessa Nelson not only mocks the bracelet, but she also dares to threaten to destroy it. She is a dead meat.

CONNER
(laughing)
It's just a cheap plastic bracelet.
(MORE)

CONNER (CONT'D)
If my daughter wants to smash it, it’s an honor for you. Name your price, I’ll fucking buy it.

CLAIRE
You can’t afford it. That bracelet is worth more than every life in your Nelson family!

Conner frowns angrily, while Ethan’s family ridicules Claire, pointing at her.

VANESSA
You old whore! How dare you speak so boldly about the Nelson family!

CLAIRE
I’ll say it one last time, give me the bracelet. Otherwise, I will have your whole family wiped out immediately!

Claire’s gaze is fierce, Vanessa dismisses her contemptuously.

VANESSA
Fine, old hag. Open your eyes and watch the bracelet...

Vanessa lets go of her grip, and the bracelet falls to the ground with a thud.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Damn it! Let’s see you play around now!

Vanessa’s high heel stomps down onto the bracelet face, shattering it instantly, and she continues to grind it beneath her heel.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Keep pretending! Keep pretending!

Ethan looks pleased. Haley stares in shock at the ruined bracelet. Claire’s eyes widen as she watches the bracelet, feeling both shocked and heartbroken.

EP 39

69 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 69

Claire pushes Vanessa away, shouting.

CLAIRE
Get out of my way!

Claire stares blankly at the shattered bracelet on the ground, heartbroken.

ASHLEY
(panicking)
This is going to ruin everything! The Nelson family will be beyond saving!

VANESSA
Old hag, I've crushed your bracelet to pieces—what can you do to me? Hit me?

Claire glowers at Vanessa, then looks down at the bracelet. She collapses to the ground, gasping for breath. Slowly, she picks up the bracelet, but the pieces scatter all around her. Unable to hold back, Claire starts to sob, trying to piece the bracelet back together. The sharp edges cut her hands, drawing blood, but she doesn't stop.

CLAIRE
I'm sorry, my daughter... I'm so sorry...

Claire grips the bracelet tightly to her chest, tears streaming down her face.

Close-up on her palm, which bleeds from the pressure on the bracelet.

Haley, furiously eyeing Vanessa, kneels down to comfort Claire.

HALEY
Ma'am, are you okay?

VANESSA
Enough! You two dying bitches better kneel down and apologize to me! Otherwise, your fate will be worse than that bracelet!

Haley helps Claire up. Claire gazes at the bracelet, sobs while speaking fiercely.

CLAIRE
Vanessa Nelson, you are dead! I will wipe out your entire family once and for all.

Conner and Vanessa share a disdainful glance and smirk.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
(To Ashley)
Go make the call.

Ashley looks at Claire with concern.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
(shouting)
Make the call!

ASHLEY
Yes!

Ashley hurriedly takes out her phone and leaves.

70 INT. BRIAN'S OFFICE BUILDING - DAY 70

Brian is giving a speech to FIVE EXECUTIVES.

BRIAN
Listen up! Today is the day Ms. Winbury reunites with her daughter. The big shots from headquarters will all be there, so you all better be on your toes!

CROWD
(bowing)
Yes!

Brian's phone RINGS, He immediately answers respectfully.

BRIAN
Miss Taylor, what can I do for you?
(angrily)
What?!
(beat)
I'll be there right away!

Brian hangs up the phone and continues his speech.

BRIAN (cont'd)
I must arrive at EverFresh before noon!

CROWD
Yes!

The crowd follows Brian as he leaves.

EP 40

71 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 71

Haley is wrapping a bandage around Claire's wrist. Conner hands on his hips, stands with a mocking grin, glancing at the wall clock that shows 11:50.

CONNER
I didn't mishear, right? Before twelve o'clock? You're telling me that with just one phone call, you managed to get the regional manager here in ten minutes?
(feigns fear)
Who are you? Haha!

Haley and Claire glare daggers at him. Vanessa smirks alongside Marissa.

VANESSA
Stop acting! You couldn't even get the city branch manager here, let alone someone higher up.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)
Mr. Scott Watts, Regional Manager, has arrived!

Everyone's attention snaps to the entrance as Watts steps in, smiling.

GUEST 1
Oh my God, she actually got the regional manager here? Who is this woman?

GUEST 2
The Nelson family might really be in deep trouble now!

Hearing this, Ethan's expression falters with worry. Seeing Watts, Conner immediately switches to an obsequious demeanor.

CONNER
Ah, Mr. Watts... Welcome!

WATTS
With such a big celebration at your factory, I had to stop by to offer my congratulations.

CONNER
Congratulations? Oh, you mean my daughter's engagement today?

Vanessa, adjusts her dress, beams at Watts, Watts looks at her with confusion.

CONNER (cont'd)
You're too kind, sparing time from your busy schedule to join us. Let me make sure we have a toast together later!

WATTS
Engagement?

VANESSA
That's right, Mr. Watts. Please wait just a moment while I deal with these lunatics. Afterward, I'll book the finest restaurant for us to celebrate with drinks!

Haley, fuming, stares at Vanessa while Claire smirks disdainfully.

CONNER
Enough stalling. Break these two bitches' legs and toss them out!

VANESSA
You heard my dad!

As Watts walk forward, his eyes meet Claire's. His face pales, and stumbles.

WATTS
Ms...

EP 41

72 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 72

GRACE
(overjoyed)
The regional manager himself came to Miss Nelson's engagement party! The Nelson family is really something!
(To Ethan)
Brother, you must hold onto the Nelson family tightly!

ADAM
(eagerly nodding)
Exactly, exactly!

ETHAN
Of course!
(takes Vanessa's hand)
Babe, we were almost fooled by that wretched woman Haley! Don't go soft on her. Otherwise, she'll just keep clinging to me!

Haley, fists clenched, holds back her anger as Vanessa looks triumphant.

VANESSA
Fine!
(Handing a baton to Ethan)
You take care of Haley—break her legs.
(Pointing to Claire)
And I'll handle this old hag myself!

Watts, now ghostly pale, clutches his chest, staggering backward. Conner rushes to steady him.

CONNER
Mr. Scott, you all right? Please don't get angry, I'll throw out this old hag immediately. Hurry!

Ethan heard Conner, holding a club, pointing it menacingly at Haley.

ETHAN
Haley, a lowly woman like you isn't even worthy of thinking about me! I'll make sure you spend the rest of your life in a wheelchair!

VANESSA
Exactly!

She shifts her gaze to Claire.

VANESSA (cont'd)
And you! Old hag! You dare oppose the Nelson family? Today, I'll make you grovel on the ground like a dead dog, begging for my forgiveness! Guards! Hold them down!

The Bodyguards move forward. Haley quickly moves and shields Claire.

HALEY
Don’t you dare! Ma’am, run! I’ll hold them off!

Ethan and Vanessa sneer mockingly, their faces filled with disdain.

CLAIRE
(calmly, with steely defiance)
Child, don’t worry. The ones who will end up groveling like dead dogs are these scumbag!

VANESSA
(laughing)
You’ve got quite the mouth! Get them!

The bodyguards charge forward.

WATTS
Stop!

EP 42

73 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 73

Watts rushes forward, raising his hand to stop the chaos. Conner hesitates.

CONNER
Mr. Watts, is something wrong?

VANESSA
Mr. Watts, do you want to handle this personally? Oh, come on, leave this to me. It’s really not worth your time.

CONNER
Exactly, Mr. Watts. My daughter and I can take care of this easily.

Suddenly, Watts slaps Conner hard across the face. Gasps echo through the room as Ethan and the others freeze in shock.

WATTS
Nonsense! The Nelson family is finished!

VANESSA
The Nelson family... finished?

Watts turns and delivers a slap to Vanessa as well.

VANESSA (cont'd)
Ah!

ETHAN
(rushing to her side, worried)
Vanessa!

VANESSA
(stunned)
Mr. Watts... you?

WATTS
You blind fool!
(pointing at Claire)
Do you have any idea who you just attacked?

VANESSA
Mr. Scott, she... she’s just some old hag!

WATTS
(fury building)
Idiot!

Watts slaps Vanessa again, leaving her in utter disbelief.

EP 43

74 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 74

Conner, observing the scene, feels his heart ache but doesn’t dare intervene.

WATTS
You reckless imbeciles! Who do you think you’re messing with? The Nelson family’s doomed today!

Conner looks utterly confused, his face contorted in desperation.

CONNER
Mr. Scott, there must been some misunderstanding! Look at her—this old woman walked out wearing a child’s bracelet. How could she possibly be important?

Claire, holding the bracelet that’s now bandaged to her wrist, sneers coldly.

CLAIRE
This bracelet... was a gift from my daughter. And you bastards actually destroyed it. Now, then, I’ll destroy the entire Nelson family in return!

The Nelsons glare at Claire, their faces twisted in suspicion and fear.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
Scott Watts.

WATTS
(immediately bowing respectfully)
Yes, ma’am!

CLAIRE
(fierce tone)
Show them hell.

WATTS
(nodding firmly)
Understood!

Watts strides forward and slaps Conner, his expression filled with disdain.

WATTS (cont'd)
Conner Nelson, your wicked deeds have caught up to you! From this moment forward, you are permanently removed from the Hailsbury Group!

Conner staggers backward, Applause erupts from Haley’s colleagues.

WATTS (cont'd)
And every member of the Nelson family is blacklisted by the Hailsbury Group! Every company collaborating with Hailsbury is forbidden from employing anyone associated with the Nelson family!

The Nelsons, including Ethan, are dumbstruck with disbelief. Conner, terrified, stares wide-eyed, on the verge of fainting.

EP 44

75 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 75

Conner, clutching his chest, falls to his knees, his face contorted in despair. He pounds the floor weakly as he speaks.

CONNER
(stammering)
Bl... Blacklist? This... this is the end. The Nelson family is ruined... completely ruined!

Conner collapses in anguish. Vanessa rushes forward, supports him.

VANESSA
Dad! Are you okay? This can’t be real, can it?

Ethan bolts to Claire, panicked, and drops to his knees, pleading.

ETHAN
Our Weston family has nothing to do with them! Please, don’t wipe out the Weston family too!

Ethan’s family joins him, bowing low before Claire, their faces full of fear.

CLAIRE
(coldly, with emphasis)
The Weston family...
(beat)
...will also be blacklisted!

ETHAN
(collapsing in despair)
No... no, it’s over. The Weston family is finished too...

Haley looks at Ethan with a mix of pity and sadness. Around him, Ethan’s family begins to crumble, each falling to their knees in hopelessness.

MARISSA / ADAM / GRACE
(overlapping voices, wailing)
What do we do now?! / It’s all over! / There’s no way out of this!

The NARRATOR interrupts the chaos.

NARRATOR (O.S.)
Ms. Kayla Lange, from Hailsbury Group's State Branch, arrives to award Mr. Ethan Weston a $5 million prize for his recipe.

All eyes turn toward the entrance.

Kayla Lange enters the room with a dominance. THREE FEMALE ATTENDANTS carry trays, and six suited male attendants follow, each holding briefcases.

EP 45

76 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 76

Ethan, startled, scrambles to his feet, his eyes wide with anticipation. Around him, the guests are equally stunned by Kayla's grandeur.

GUEST 1
Isn't that Kayla Lange? Her father is the State Branch General Manager of Hailsbury Group!

GUEST 2
A person of her status showing up to personally congratulate Ethan Weston? Unbelievable!

Kayla approaches Ethan with a poised smile.

KAYLA
Mr. Weston, on behalf of Hailsbury Group, congratulations on your winning recipe.

Kayla claps lightly. The male Attendants in unison open their briefcases, revealing stacks of cash. The sight of the money leaves Ethan's eye sparkling.

KAYLA (cont'd)
This $5 million prize belongs to you.

Vanessa and Conner, still on their knees, stare at the money in disbelief as whispers ripple through the crowd.

KAYLA (cont'd)
And as authorized by My father personally, Mr. Weston will join the State Branch as my father's first secretary, with an annual salary of $10 million!

ETHAN
(shocked, overjoyed)
What?!

Ethan's family, overwhelmed by the announcement, cling to each other, their emotions teetering between joy and fainting.

KAYLA
Here is your appointment letter.

Kayla gracefully takes the letter from one of the attendants and hands it to Ethan with both hands.

Haley clenches her fists, while Claire remains composed.

ETHAN
A personal secretary to the State Branch General Manager... with a $10 million salary?!

EP 46

77 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 77

Ethan, ecstatic, takes the letter with both hands, his face beaming.

ETHAN
I can't believe it—I'm going to be the secretary to the State Branch General Manager!

Vanessa and Conner exchange a look, awe and hope flickering in their eyes.

VANESSA
Oh my God, that's the Hailsbury Group's State Branch! If Ethan becomes the General Manager's first secretary, the Weston family could even join America's top elite families!

Hearing this, Ethan stands even taller, clutching the letter with pride. Around him, his family begins to exude smugness, their previous despair forgotten.

KAYLA
Mr. Weston, my father is looking forward to your joining. As a token of his personal regard, I brought you two gifts.
(MORE)

KAYLA (CONT'D)
(gesturing to the attendants)
The first, is a custom Rolls-Royce, valued at $1 million. The second, is an ocean-view villa worth $20 million. Please, accept them.

Close-up of a tray holding the Rolls-Royce keys and the property deed. The Weston family gasps in delight.

ETHAN
(grinning ear to ear)
Miss Lange, you're far too generous!

Haley looks disappointed. Marissa's eyes gleam with calculation.

MARISSA
(leaning toward Ethan)
Son, now the State Branch General Manager values you so highly, the blacklist of a mere city branch manager's is of no use, right?

ETHAN
Of course! The tables have turned. Now...
(glaring at Claire)
...it's my turn to deal with this old hag!

CLAIRE
(sneering)
Deal with me? You?

ETHAN
(brandish the appointment letter)
I'm now the first Secretary to the State Branch General Manager! Do you really think Scott Watts can still protect you?

Claire, unfazed, chuckles softly. But Haley looks increasingly uneasy.

HALEY
Ma'am, the State Branch executives are powerful. There's no need for you to go against them just for me.

Kayla, hands clasped behind her back, exudes arrogance.

CLAIRE
(calm and gentle, to Haley)
Don’t worry, child. Ethan’s newfound arrogance (beat) will soon vanish.

EP 47

78 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 78

Ethan glares at Claire, his tone sharp and aggressive.

ETHAN
Old hag, how dare you spew such nonsense!

Kayla glances at Ethan, then at Claire, her expression thoughtful.

KAYLA (V.O.)
Ethan Weston is high valued by the chairwoman. If I can make him happy, my father is bound to skyrocket in his career. Someone actually dares to challenge him. My chance has come.

Kayla steps forward, pointing a finger at Claire.

KAYLA
Old hag, Listen, Today's awards ceremony and Mr. Weston's appointment are orders directly from Hailsbury Group headquarters. Do you know the consequences of disrespecting Mr. Weston?

CLAIRE
(smirking coldly)
Do you even know who I am?

KAYLA
I don’t care who you are! Offending Mr. Weston is the same as offending me, Kayla Lange! You and that little wretch behind you—kneel down and apologize to Mr. Weston right now, and don’t stop until he’s satisfied!

Ethan crosses his arms smugly, looking to Haley with a self-satisfied grin.

CLAIRE
Threaten me? Do you think you're worthy?!

KAYLA
Are you looking down on me?

Kayla Sneers, Ethan steps forward to stand beside Kayla.

ETHAN
Miss Lange, this old hag is incredibly arrogant. Not only did she threaten me, she also demanded that your father be here by 12.
(looking at Claire)
—she only gave him 10 minutes!

EP 48

79 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 79

Kayla's expression turns incredulous as she points to the floor.

KAYLA
Order my father be here in 10 minutes?

ETHAN
And five minutes have already passed.

Close-up of the banquet clock, showing 11:55 a.m.

KAYLA
(laughing mockingly)
Are you delusional? My father is the general manager of Hailsbury Group's state division, and he's highly valued by the chairwoman. How dare you make up such nonsense, I'll cut out your tongue!

Unable to stand it any longer, Watts steps forward to intervene.

WATTS
Kayla Lange, you're out of line!

Kayla slowly turns to Watts, feigning surprise.

KAYLA
Oh! Isn't this old Scott from the city division? What's this?
(MORE)

KAYLA (CONT'D)
(pointing at Claire)
You’re standing up for her now?

WATTS
Kayla Lange, offending her will be the downfall of your family!

Kayla suddenly slaps Watts very hard across the face. The room is stunned.

Haley seethes with anger, while Vanessa, Ethan, and their family look on with smug satisfaction. Kayla points at Watts again, her tone triumphant.

KAYLA
This entire state is under Lange family’s control! Who could possibly bring us down!

Kayla kicks Watts, who falls to the ground. Desperate, he pleads with her.

WATTS
Child, stop this! When your father arrives, you’ll soon realize the trouble you’ve caused!

KAYLA
When my father gets here? Ha! The only thing that will happen is you and that old hag will suffer! In this state, going against the Lange family is like provoking the gods themselves!

EP 49

80 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 80

Ethan raises a thumb, his expression sycophantic.

ETHAN
Miss Lange, you are the most beautiful and commanding woman I’ve ever seen! Even the city branch manager didn’t dare to fight back.

Haley’s eyes burn with anger. Kayla brims with confidence, smiles smugly.

Grace, arms crossed, holds her head high, while Marissa beams with pride. The guests murmur uneasily among themselves. Claire scorns.

CLAIRE
The so-called Lange family—what gives you the audacity to be this arrogant?

KAYLA
(narrowing her eyes at Claire)
Oh? So even the Lange family isn't good enough for you? Who do you think you are?

ETHAN
(sycophantically to Kayla)
Miss Lange, this old hag is probably Scott's mistress. Earlier, she even threatened to blacklist my family from the Hailsbury Group! You should teach her a lesson!

KAYLA
Rest assured, Mr. Weston—I'll make sure she pays dearly.

ETHAN
Thank you, Miss Lange!

Kayla strides confidently toward Claire, her gaze predatory.

EP 50

81 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 81

Kayla stops in front of Claire, while Ashley quickly steps forward to shield her.

KAYLA
(examining Claire, mockingly)
Well, on a closer look, you're well-maintained for your age. How about this—
(pointing at floor)
Kneel down, apologize to Mr. Weston, and be my servant—carry my bags, massage my shoulders—and I might just let you off.

Ethan, arms crossed, smirks smugly. Ashley is furious.

ASHLEY
Outrageous! You insolent fool!

Ashley glances at the clock.

INSERT: CLOCK FACE

The time reads 11:56. Ashley grits her teeth.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
In four minutes, you'll realize how foolish you've been. And crying for mercy won't help!

Kayla, enraged, slaps Ashley, sending her sprawling to the floor.

KAYLA
(pointing at Ashley)
Who the fuck are you to talk back to me!

Ashley, still on the ground, glares at Kayla, fury smoldering in her eyes.

EP 51

82 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 82

Claire help Ashley to her feet. Ashley looks daggers at Kayla.

CLAIRE
(furious, shouting at Kayla)
Kayla Lange, are you seeking death! Do you even know who I am?!

KAYLA
I don't care who you are! Today, my father sent me here to deliver gifts to Mr. Weston. Whoever offends him today will answer to me!

ETHAN
(approaching Claire smugly)
Old hag, aren't you arrogant? Siding with that loser Haley? I'll make sure you're crying and begging for mercy today!

Haley, trembling with suppressed rage, clenches her fists as she watches Ethan. Claire, unflinching, points at Ethan and Kayla calmly.

CLAIRE
Ethan Weston, the one who'll be crying and begging for mercy today... is you. And him. No one can save either of you!

KAYLA
(scoffing)
Ridiculous! As long as my father is the State Branch General Manager of Hailsbury Group, no one in this state can make me kneel!

CLAIRE
Your father can't save you either. Brian Lange will also pay for what you did!

KAYLA
What did you say?!

Claire glances at the clock.

INSERT: CLOCK FACE

The time reads 11:57.

CLAIRE
Three minutes. You, your father, and Ethan Weston will all kneel and beg for mercy.

KAYLA
(mocking laugh)
Three minutes, I'll give you three seconds—kneel and apologize to me and Mr. Weston! Otherwise, I'll have my men strip you bare and hand you over to the crowd!

Kayla signals to the guards, who begin approaching Claire with lecherous grins. Haley, outraged, steps forward and slaps Kayla, nearly knocking her over.

HALEY
Don't touch her!

83 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 83

Kayla clutches her face, her eyes burning with fury as she glares at Haley. Conner, looking serious, nudges Vanessa with his elbow.

CONNER
Haley is doomed! Miss Kayla Lange is infamous for holding grudges!

VANESSA
That little wretch deserves it! She humiliated me. Even if she died ten thousand times, it wouldn’t ease my anger!

Ethan checks on Kayla with concern, then glares furiously at Haley.

ETHAN
You filthy mutt! Do you want to lose your dirty paws?!

KAYLA
Wretch! You’ve got guts to shove me! Do you have any idea how much weight the Lange family carries in this entire state?!

Haley, her voice firm and resolute, steps forward to confront Kayla head-on.

HALEY
I don’t care how powerful your family is! As long as I’m here, I won’t let you hurt Madam!

Claire standing behind Haley, watches her with pride and deep emotion.

KAYLA
(laughing mockingly)
“You won’t”?

Kayla steps forward and kicks Claire hard, sending her sprawling to the ground. Ethan and Vanessa smirk, delighted by the spectacle.

KAYLA (cont'd)
Who the hell are you? My father is the State Branch General Manager!
(to Haley with venom)
And you? A motherless stray—how dare you challenge me?

84 EXT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 84

A convoy of cars pulls up outside the venue. The door of the lead luxury car opens, and Brian Lange steps out, checking his watch anxiously.

BRIAN
Two minutes left. I made it just in time.

One of Brian Lange's ASSISTANT approaches him, concern evident in their voice.

BRIAN'S ASSISTANT
Mr. Lange, is something wrong with the award ceremony? You seem unusually anxious.

BRIAN
(cold, with menace)
Someone dared to disrespect Ms. Winbury. I'm going to end him, Follow me!

Brian strides to the banquet hall, followed by his 2 assistants.

EP 53

85 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 85

Claire, her expression tight with concern, rushes to Haley, kneeling beside her.

CLAIRE
Haley, are you all right?

HALEY
I'm fine, ma'am. It's my fault. I dragged you into this mess.

CLAIRE
(voice steady)
I'll make whoever bullies you pay. The Langes are no exception!

Claire rises, her gaze locking onto Kayla, cold and unyielding.

KAYLA
That's the most ridiculous thing I've ever heard!
(MORE)

KAYLA (CONT'D)
You’re nothing more than a lover of a city branch manager. Make my family pay?

ETHAN
Old hag, Just one word from Miss Lange, you and Haley will be utterly destroyed!

GRACE
Brother, don’t forget-
(snickering, pointing at Haley)
Haley’s just an orphan. She doesn’t even have anything to destroy!

ETHAN
Perfect. Then we can just beat her to death and reunite her with her family down in hell!

CLAIRE
(cold and cutting)
Ethan Weston, it seems you’ve forgotten the earlier lessons. Have you forgotten how you were kneeling just moments ago?

Ethan, embarrassed, falters.

ETHAN
Old hag, we have the Lange family backing us now. Don’t get cocky!

CLAIRE
(calm but fierce)
The Lange family won’t even be able to protect themselves today.

KAYLA
Oh, really?

Kayla strides up to Claire and stomps hard on her shoe, grinding it underfoot. Claire glances down, furrowing slightly. Haley clenches her fists in fury.

KAYLA (cont'd)
I can crush you like a bug under my foot.
(Watts freezes in shock)
A woman like you should be wearing ragged shoes. That’s the only thing that suits your lowly status.

CLAIRE
Mark my words.
(glances at the clock)
In one minute, you'll be on your knees, licking my shoes clean.

Kayla slightly shaking her head with a smirk, saunters closer to Claire, then suddenly slaps her across the face. The room falls silent in stunned shock.

EP 55

86 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 86

Vanessa and her father clap gleefully. Haley rushes to help Claire up.

HALEY
Ma'am, are you okay?

Claire, holding her cheek, reassures Haley with a faint smile.

CLAIRE
I'm fine.

KAYLA
No more mercy.
(to the guards)
Strip her naked! Let's see if her body's as well-maintained as her face!

The 3 Guards moves. Haley steps in front of Claire and points at the guards.

HALEY
You animals! Is there no law here?

KAYLA
(sneering)
Oh, you little wretch, so desperate to die? I'll grant your wish first. Beat her to death!

The 3 guards surround Haley. She pushes one away, but another slaps her hard, sending her to the ground. The guards begin to mercilessly beat her.

Haley, powerless, curls into a ball, shielding her head with her arms, very much in pain. Claire, frantic, tries to intervene but is shoved away by a guard.

CLAIRE
(shouting)
Child!

EP 56

87 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 87

CLAIRE
(furious, glaring at the attackers)
You animals! I'll make you suffer endlessly!

KAYLA
Didn't you say you'll have my dad here in 10 minutes? Well, there's only five seconds left!

Kayla points at the clock. All eyes turn to it, its second hand ticking loudly.

INSERT: CLOCK FACE

The second hand counts down: 5... 4... 3... 2... 1...

The 3 guards are still beating Haley, who is clutching her head in agony. Claire, helpless, watches in anguish. Ashley holds her back, prevents her from injury.

The clock strikes 12:00, its chime resounding through the hall.

KAYLA (cont'd)
Time's up! Where's he?!

Ethan, arms crossed, tilts his head back, his expression smug and triumphant.

KAYLA (cont'd)
Pretentious nonsense! Let's see who dares to stop me now! Strip the old hag!

NARRATOR (O.S.)
Brian Lange, The State Branch General Manager, has arrived!

Gasps ripple through the crowd as everyone turns toward the entrance.

Brian Lange, flanked by his Entourage, strides into the hall with dominance.

EP 57

88 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 88

Vanessa stares to the entrance, her face a mixture of disbelief and confusion.

VANESSA
No way... The State Branch General Manager is really here?

CONNER
This can’t be true...

Ethan, his smug expression fading, stands visibly shaken.

ETHAN
How’s that possible? Did that old hag really manage to summon the General Manager?

Brian Lange strides into the hall with urgency. Kayla adjusts her clothes.

KAYLA
My father is here to greet the Chairwoman.

ETHAN
(eyes lighting up in surprise)
What? The Chairwoman?

MARISSA
Does that mean the Chairman of the Hailsbury Group is personally attending my son’s award ceremony? Oh my God! Our Weston family is about to leap into success!

Grace claps her hands with joy. Brian Lange stops in front of Kayla.

KAYLA
(smiling)
Dad, I’ve already presented the gifts to Mr. Weston, and he’s very pleased.

BRIAN
(waving dismissively)
That’s irrelevant now. Where is Ms. Winbury?

KAYLA
The Chairwoman? She hasn't arrived yet.

BRIAN
(glaring)
How could that be! Ten minutes ago, Ms. Winbury's secretary called me, saying someone is disrespecting her
(voice rising)
I'll kill that insolent fool!

Claire stands calm, remaining silent. Kayla and Ethan are shocked.

ETHAN
Ten minutes ago?!

The crowd GASPS. All heads turn in unison toward Claire.

CLAIRE
(voice cold and commanding)
Brian Lange, open your eyes wide and take a good look at who I am!

Brian locks eyes with Claire and freezes. His expression shifts to utter shock.

EP 58

89 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 89

The room falls silent. The tension is thick as Brian slowly approaches Claire. His movements are deliberate, he kneels on one knee before Claire, bowing.

BRIAN
Ms. Winbury, I humbly greet you.

The crowd recoils, gasping audibly. They instinctively take a step back as a wave of murmurs sweeps through the room.

Haley widens her eyes in utter disbelief.

Claire, hands clasped behind her back, tilts her head slightly upward with dominance. Conner, Vanessa, Kayla, and others stumble backward, stunned.

The crowd erupts in murmurs of shock and confusion.

ETHAN
What? She… she's the Chairwoman?

KAYLA
(in disbelief)
How... how is this possible?

BRIAN
(to Kayla)
Kneel immediately! Standing before you is the ruler of global finance, the chairwoman of the world’s number one corporation—Hailsbury Group!

Ethan stumbles, nearly collapsing to his knees, frozen in shock. Kayla’s face pales, her body trembling uncontrollably.

KAYLA
She... she’s the chairwoman? I’m doomed. Our family is doomed...

Her legs give out, and she collapses to the ground. Claire, with her hands behind her back, raises her head with an imposing presence.

CLAIRE
Brian Lange.

Brian immediately turns to Claire. Claire’s voice is fierce.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
You’ve raised a fine daughter, haven’t you? She slapped me and tried to strip me in front of everyone to humiliate me! The Lange family—truly untouchable!

BRIAN
(shocked)
W-what?!

Brian’s disbelief shifts to pure terror. Kayla is kneeling while shaking violently.

EP 60

90 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 90

BRIAN
Ms. Winbury, please calm your anger!

Brian rises to his feet, grabs Kayla roughly, and slaps her across the face.

BRIAN (cont'd)
It is you? Are you insane?! How dare you did that to Ms. Winbury? Do you want to drag our entire family to the grave with you?!

KAYLA
(panicking, stammering)
Dad, this is a misunderstanding! I didn’t know she was the Chairwoman!

Brian slaps her again, this time on the other cheek.

BRIAN
You’re beyond redemption! Because of you, our family faces utter destruction!

KAYLA
No....

In desperation, Kayla grabs Ethan and shoves him forward. Ethan is terrified.

KAYLA (cont'd)
It’s all his fault! This bastard told me to offend Ms. Winbury!

ETHAN
No, no, no!

Kayla slaps Ethan to the floor. Everyone gasps in shock. Kayla then whirls toward Vanessa and strikes her hard across the face.

KAYLA
And you, bitch! You are the one wanted to break Ms. Winbury’s legs! It has nothing to do with me!

Vanessa, knocked to the ground, scrambles up, her face pale with fear.

VANESSA
I, I didn’t know she was the Chairwoman!

Vanessa grows frantic, then slaps Ethan across the face too.

VANESSA (cont'd)
It’s all his fault! That brute manipulated me—he’s the one who ruined everything!

Ethan, already weakened, as a tooth flies out of his mouth as he falls to the floor.

EP 61

91 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 91

Vanessa rushes toward Claire and falls to her knees. The Nelsons follows suit. Ethan crawls on his knees to Claire, his family follows suit.

VANESSA
Ms. Winbury, I was wrong—I truly know now! Please, I beg you, spare the Nelson family!

CONNER
(bowing low)
Chairman, please forgive us. Be magnanimous and show mercy.

ETHAN
Ms. Winbury, I know I was wrong! Please, spare my life! Just spare me! Please!

GUEST 1
Oh my God, it really is the Chairwoman of Hailsbury Group!

GUEST 2
(amazed)
I can’t believe I have the privilege to witness the Chairwoman in person!

CLAIRE
(coldly)
Too late! You bullied Haley, and I said I’d make you pay back a thousandfold!

TWO ASSISTANTS carry in an ornate chair and place it prominently on the stage.

Ashley, holding a crown, approaches with a solemn air, puts it on Claire, then steps aside.

Claire turns and walks to the chair with dignity. She sits gracefully. Her eyes sweep over the kneeling crowd from her throne. Everyone is impressed.

EP 62

92 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 92

Ethan stands up, his face twisted with defiance and disbelief.

ETHAN
I just don't get it! Why would someone as powerful as you side with a orphan like Haley!

Haley bites her lip and lowers her head, silent but deeply hurt.

CLAIRE
Why? Because she...

Claire turns to Haley, her expression softening, her voice filled with warmth.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
(gently)
...is the daughter I've owed for twenty years!

Haley stares at Claire, stunned, unable to process. Ethan's jaw drops in disbelief, collapses to his knees. Everyone in the room are shocked, then erupt with loud whispers as the revelation spreads.

Claire takes off the necklace, and picks up the one that Haley is wearing. She brings the two pieces together, forming a complete pendant. Tears stream down Claire's face as she cups Haley's cheeks lovingly.

CLAIRE (cont'd)
(choking on her words)
I'm mom... I'm mom!

EP 63

93 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 93

Haley, overwhelmed, places her hands on her head as dizziness washes over her. She stares at the reunited necklace in Claire's hands, then looks up at her mother, tears streaming down her face.

HALEY
(voice trembling)
I remember now! Are you recovered?
(sobbing, louder)
Mom!

Claire, weeping, nods and pulls Haley into a tight embrace.

CLAIRE
Mommy's better now. Now that I'm here, no one will dare bully you again.

Ethan, still kneeling, stares at Haley, his voice quivering in disbelief.

ETHAN
Haley, is the heiress of the Hailsbury Group?

VANESSA
I'm doomed, Haley, the Chairwoman's daughter?

MARISSA
(despairing)
My family could've risen to the top... but now it's all over. Everything is ruined!

Ethan, panicking, scrambles to his feet and grabs Haley's arm pleading.

ETHAN
It's all a misunderstanding! Haley, I was wrong! Forgive me—I'll treat you well. Don't you remember how much you loved me?

EP 64

94 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 94

Haley shoves Ethan away, her voice filled with disgust.

HALEY
Ethan Weston, what you are doing only makes me sick!

CLAIRE
Vanessa Nelson, you struck my daughter, destroyed the bracelet my daughter gave me. And you—
(Claire turns to Ethan, in fury)
You toyed with my daughter's feelings and trampled on her sincerity!
(turns to Kayla)
And you...
(MORE)

CLAIRE (CONT'D)
you let those beasts lay their hands on my dear daughter. Guards!

Guards armed with batons encircle Vanessa, Ethan and Kayla. They back away in terror, their voices rising in panic.

VANESSA/ETHAN/KAYLA
(screaming)
No, no! Please don’t! Ahhh!

The guards descend on them, their batons striking with brutal force. Their screams echo through the hall. Claire remains calm.

Claire gently wipes away Haley’s tears, her expression softening. She removes the crown from her own head and places it delicately on Haley’s.

CLAIRE
(smiling warmly)
Haley, from this moment on, you are the sole heiress to the Hailsbury Group!
(with a teasing laugh)
And this time, make sure you choose wisely—find yourself a good boyfriend.

The guests, overhearing this, erupt into a frenzy. One after another, they rush forward, dropping to one knee before Haley to propose.

GUEST A
Miss Davis, please marry me!

Another guest pushes forward, kneeling eagerly.

GUEST B
Miss Davis, I’m the one you should marry!

One after another, the guests kneel, their voices merging into a chorus.

GUESTS
(in unison)
Miss Davis, please marry me!

Haley, overwhelmed by the spectacle, glances at Claire, unsure how to respond. Claire, smiling, meets her gaze with encouragement.

HALEY
Mom, from now on, we'll never be apart again.

CLAIRE
Never. Now, let's go home.

The kneeling crowd parts immediately, creating a clear path. Claire holds Haley's hand tightly, they walk to the exit, their eyes brimming with tears but their expressions resolute.

END